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*Together makes progress*



# Deloitte Language and Style Guide

**May 2026**

**CONFIDENTIAL**

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# Introduction

## What is the purpose of this guide?

When Deloitte professionals communicate in a clear, confident, human style using consistent terminology and following established quality, legal and risk review processes, we deliver a consistent, differentiated brand experience to internal and external stakeholders.

This document provides guidance on important terminology and phrases and answers some of the most common questions about word choices, required legal language and legal reviews to help all professionals communicate with "One Deloitte Voice."

## Who should use this guide?

All Deloitte firms and their related entities are expected to follow this guidance.

Deloitte firms and their related entities should adhere to local spelling and punctuation conventions. However, communications produced by Deloitte Global—regardless of their country of origin—are expected to follow this guidance.

Deloitte firms that wish to distribute a communication outside of their jurisdiction(s) need explicit approval from the relevant Deloitte firm(s) where they want to distribute the communication. For example, Deloitte North and South Europe must secure permission from Deloitte Asia Pacific to distribute a thought leadership piece in China.

Deloitte Global OGC/Risk should be notified and given the opportunity to review any Deloitte firm communication that will be distributed globally.

Local laws and regulations take precedence over this guidance. Therefore, please consult with your Deloitte firm Legal and/or Risk teams if you have any questions relating to this guide.

Deloitte Insights follows the Deloitte Language and Style Guide with some strategic exceptions. Deloitte Insights more wholly adheres to the business publishing standard of Associated Press style to help ensure that Deloitte's externally published thought leadership is communicated similarly to other top-tier business insights from known publishers. When publishing with Deloitte Insights, please refer to the Deloitte Insights Style Guide for more information.

## What types of communication does this guide cover?

The required legal language must be used in all internal and external business communications including, but not limited to, emails, business correspondence, newsletters, thought-leadership pieces, educational materials, press releases (including joint press releases with third parties), articles, advertisements, invitations to events, brochures, audio-visual materials, presentations, speeches, recruiting materials, online materials (e.g., materials posted on Deloitte.com and Deloitte firm websites), social media materials (e.g., blogs and posts on sites such as Facebook, Twitter, LinkedIn, Google+), media and other types of interviews, competition/award submissions, podcasts and books.

The nature of the communication, not the method of distribution (e.g., written, verbal or via the internet, including social media platforms), determines whether it is a personal communication or a business communication. For example, use of a personal social media platform to redistribute Deloitte communications does not change the fact that such communication is considered a business communication and, therefore, would be subject to this guidance. See confidentiality for additional information.

Some guidance may not be appropriate for all types of communications. For example, in certain contexts, extra care must be taken to be clear which Deloitte firms are providing services to specific clients, such as in the audit, tax and legal spaces; in legal contracts, proposals and engagement letters; in regulatory communications; and in certain other official communications. Local laws and regulations should take precedence over this guidance. Therefore, consult with your local Deloitte firm Legal and/or Risk teams, as needed.

# Introduction

## What's new in this edition?

Updates in the May 2026 edition include:

- Revised *industry groups* (p. 16), *client names and logos* (use of) (p. 19), *Deloitte's Purpose* and *Deloitte University* (p. 21), *European Union* (p. 35), *net-zero* (p. 39)
- New guidance on *GenAI-generated content and text* (p. 10-11), *Agentic AI, Sovereign AI, Physical AI* (p. 11),
- Updated guidance on *Global qualified review process* (p. 9), *Qualified reviewers validating citations and sources* (p.10), *GenAI-generated images* (p.11), *locations* (p. 13), *Big Four* (p. 28), *more than/over* (p. 39),
- Added *Operate services vs. Operate* (p. 17), *Growth Platforms, Alliances, Ecosystems and Technology Relationships* (p. 20), *Advise-Implement-Operate (A-I-O)* (p. 21), *Global Delivery Network (GDN)* (p. 22), *IndustryAdvantage* (p. 23), *Iran conflict* (p. 37), *LinkedIn articles/posts* (p. 48), *Hyperlinking* (p. 49), *distill/distil* (p 50)

Updates in the June 2025 edition included:

- Revised *Deloitte profile* (p. 5), *Deloitte businesses* (p. 14), *client names and logos* (p. 18), *brand positioning* (p. 20), *inclusive language* (p. 25) and *metrics* (p. 38)
- New guidance on legal language for *social media ads* and *podcasts* (pp. 6, 8) and the *age of Deloitte* (p. 12)
- Updated guidance on *Deloitte business reviews* (p. 10), *capitalization* (p. 28) and *Generative AI* (p. 35)
- Added *C-suite* (p. 29), *next-gen* (p. 38), *roadmap* (p. 42) and *tweet* (p. 45)

# Required legal language and other language

**IMPORTANT NOTE**
All Deloitte firms and their related entities are expected to follow the guidance in the *Deloitte Language and Style Guide*. However, local laws and regulations take precedence over this guidance. Therefore, please consult with your Deloitte firm Legal and/or Risk teams if you have any questions relating to this guide.

For communications issued by Deloitte Global, required legal language and other language elements include:

1. standard legal description
2. Deloitte profile
3. disclaimer
4. copyright

For guidelines on how and when to use these elements, see the Deloitte Global required language applications table. All copy should be published using a readable sized font. Any modifications on Deloitte Global-issued communications, including to required legal language, must be approved by Deloitte Global OGC. Modification of the Deloitte profile must also be approved by Deloitte Global Brand.

For Deloitte Insights content, the required language and review process should adhere to the requirements of the Deloitte firm creating the content.

For Deloitte Insights content, the required language and review process should adhere to the requirements of the Deloitte firm creating the content.

Deloitte firms are expected to use the standard legal description and Deloitte profile. Required language differs among Deloitte firms; therefore, Deloitte firms should adhere to their specific Deloitte firm requirements.

Exceptions: There are certain circumstances where it may not be practical to include the full version of the required language, such as in certain kinds of advertisements. In such cases, consult your local Deloitte firm Legal and/or Risk teams.

## standard legal description

**The following legal description should be included in full on internal and external communications:**

- *Deloitte refers to one or more of Deloitte Touche Tohmatsu Limited (DTTL), its global network of member firms, and their related entities (collectively, the "Deloitte organization"). DTTL (also referred to as "Deloitte Global") and each of its member firms and related entities are legally separate and independent entities, which cannot obligate or bind each other in respect of third parties. DTTL and each DTTL member firm and related entity is liable only for its own acts and omissions, and not those of each other. DTTL does not provide services to clients. Please see www.deloitte.com/about to learn more.*

Deloitte firms are encouraged to add Deloitte firm and/or country-specific descriptions after the Standard Legal Description in consultation with their Legal and/or Risk teams.

## Deloitte profile

This language describes the attributes of Deloitte and should be included on external communications. Deloitte firms may integrate this into the language of their local profiles or may include it separately to ensure readers understand the breadth of Deloitte's global presence.

- *Deloitte provides leading professional services to nearly 90% of the Fortune Global 500® and thousands of private companies. Our people deliver measurable and lasting results that help reinforce public trust in capital markets and enable clients to transform and thrive. Building on its 180+-year history, Deloitte spans more than 150 countries and territories. Learn how Deloitte's over 470,000 people worldwide work together every day to make an impact that matters at www.deloitte.com.*

While the Deloitte profile should be applicable in the vast majority of Deloitte geographies, only in those limited instances where local regulatory restrictions exist the Deloitte profile can be customized to meet those requirements.

## disclaimers

Disclaimers should be included on internal and external communications. Please consult with your Deloitte firm Legal and/or Risk teams to ensure you use the appropriate disclaimer content for your Deloitte firm communications. NOTE: The last sentence of both disclaimers (*DTTL and each of its member firms, and their related entities, are legally separate and independent entities*) may be omitted if the disclaimer language appears below the standard legal description.

The following are the Deloitte Global disclaimers (Deloitte firms may edit to comply with local laws and regulations).

# Required legal language and other language

**IMPORTANT NOTE**
All Deloitte firms and their related entities are expected to follow the guidance in the *Deloitte Language and Style Guide*. However, local laws and regulations take precedence over this guidance. Therefore, please consult with your Deloitte firm Legal and/or Risk teams if you have any questions relating to this guide.

Deloitte Global external communications disclaimer:

- *This communication contains general information only, and none of Deloitte Touche Tohmatsu Limited (DTTL), its global network of member firms or their related entities (collectively, the "Deloitte organization") is, by means of this communication, rendering professional advice or services. Before making any decision or taking any action that may affect your finances or your business, you should consult a qualified professional adviser.*

  *No representations, warranties or undertakings (express or implied) are given as to the accuracy or completeness of the information in this communication, and none of DTTL, its member firms, related entities, employees or agents shall be liable or responsible for any loss or damage whatsoever arising directly or indirectly in connection with any person relying on this communication. DTTL and each of its member firms, and their related entities, are legally separate and independent entities.*

Deloitte Global internal communications disclaimer:

- *This communication and any attachment to it is for internal distribution among personnel of Deloitte Touche Tohmatsu Limited (DTTL), its global network of member firms and their related entities (collectively, the "Deloitte organization"). It may contain confidential information and is intended solely for the use of the individual or entity to whom it is addressed. If you are not the intended recipient, please notify us immediately, do not use this communication in any way and then delete it and all copies of it on your system.*

  *None of DTTL, its member firms, related entities, employees or agents shall be responsible for any loss or damage whatsoever arising directly or indirectly in connection with any person relying on this communication. DTTL and each of its member firms, and their related entities, are legally separate and independent entities.*

## copyright

Most communications should have a copyright. Consult with your local Deloitte firm Legal and/or Risk teams to find out the appropriate disclaimer content for your Deloitte firm communications. When combined with the standard legal description, the copyright for Deloitte Global communications should read:

- *© 2026. For information, contact Deloitte Global.*

If used alone, the copyright should read:

- *© 2026. For information, contact Deloitte Touche Tohmatsu Limited.*

Online ads (banner/social media/etc.) should include the copyright notice. However, that copyright notice can be on the site where the ad is located or on the ad itself, so if the ad is on a Deloitte platform that already includes the copyright notice, that is sufficient. If not, then the copyright notice should be included on the ad.

## Deloitte sub-brands

In addition to the required legal language and other language elements, descriptive language is recommended when a communication references a Deloitte subbrand (e.g., Deloitte Legal, etc.).

For example, the following is a description for Deloitte Private that should be included on communications issued by or referring to Deloitte Private:

- *Deloitte Private is the brand under which firms in the Deloitte network provide services to privately owned entities and high-net- worth individuals.*

For Deloitte Legal, the following description should be included on all internal and external communications issued by or referring to Deloitte Legal:

- *[LEGAL ENTITY NAME OF DELOITTE LEGAL PRACTICE] is a Deloitte Legal practice in [COUNTRY OF DELOITTE LEGAL PRACTICE]. Deloitte Legal means the legal practices of DTTL member firms, their affiliates or their related entities that provide legal services. The exact nature of these relationships and provision of legal services differs by jurisdiction, to allow compliance with local laws and professional regulations. Each Deloitte Legal practice is legally separate and independent and cannot obligate any other Deloitte Legal practice. Each Deloitte Legal practice is liable only for its own acts and omissions, and not those of other Deloitte Legal practices. For legal, regulatory and other reasons, not all member firms, their affiliates or their related entities provide legal services or are associated with Deloitte Legal practices.*

This descriptive language should be included directly below the standard legal description (and the country-specific description, if using). All other required language should continue to be used.

# Required legal language and other language

**IMPORTANT NOTE**
All Deloitte firms and their related entities are expected to follow the guidance in the *Deloitte Language and Style Guide*. However, local laws and regulations take precedence over this guidance. Therefore, please consult with your Deloitte firm Legal and/or Risk teams if you have any questions relating to this guide.

## translated communications

US English is the default language for Deloitte Global communications. If Deloitte Global distributes a document or video that was translated from another language, include the following disclaimer:

- *This communication was translated into English from another language. Its translation is provided on an informational basis only. If there is a discrepancy between this English version and its original language, the original-language version controls.*

If possible, link to the original version where it reads, *the original- language version* near the end.

If a Deloitte firm translates a Deloitte Global document from English into its local language, include the following disclaimer:

- *This communication's original language is English. Its translation into other languages is provided on an informational basis only. If there is a discrepancy between any of the translated languages and the English version, the original English version controls.*

If possible, link to the English version where it reads, *the original English version* near the end.

For Deloitte Global communications, only Deloitte Global-approved translation software should be used. At the date of publication of this section, the only translation services that are approved are available via the CoRe Open Translation team. The intranet site of the CoRe Open Translation team is available here. Deloitte people from other Deloitte firms should only use tools approved by their Deloitte firm. The use of free software applications available online is not permitted (e.g., Google Translate).

The use of translation software must be followed by a review by a Deloitte Global or Deloitte firm in-person translator, as applicable; translation software should not be solely used. It is also subject to Risk and/or Legal review in the translated language.

# Language applications

**IMPORTANT NOTE**
All Deloitte firms and their related entities are expected to follow the guidance in the *Deloitte Language and Style Guide*. However, local laws and regulations take precedence over this guidance. Therefore, please consult with your Deloitte firm Legal and/or Risk teams if you have any questions relating to this guide.

The required language applications table represents the minimum that should appear on a communication. For those cases deemed necessary or beneficial, the communication owner may add one or more of the required language elements beyond the minimum required (e.g., invitations do not require the Deloitte network profile, but it may be included along with the standard legal description). If the communication is considered thought leadership, the disclaimer should be added. Branded elements that do not appear on the required language applications table—such as gifts, wearable items and other items not listed on the required applications table—do not require any added language.

The requirements in the required language applications table must be applied to all internal and external Deloitte business communications. For communications marked with a "D" in the required language applications table, either the external communications disclaimer or the internal communications disclaimer should be used, as appropriate.

Deloitte communications with a third party (e.g., joint press releases) should include the standard legal description and the disclaimer. Should a third-party refuse to include either language, please consult with your Deloitte firm Legal and/or Risk teams.

At the end of every video, the standard legal description, appropriate (internal or external) disclaimer and copyright must be placed after the Deloitte sonic logo in a readable-sized font.

**Deloitte language applications**

| Communication | Required language |
|---|---|
| Advertisement—online banners | C |
| Annual review, global report, and quarterlies | S,P,D,C |
| Brochures | S,P,D,C |
| deloitte.com | S,D,C |
| Deloitte resources | S,D,C |
| E-cards (holiday, personal) | S,C |
| Emails | S |
| Flash microsites | S,C |
| Invitations (print, email) | S,C |
| iPhone/iPad or other mobile apps[1] | |
| Letterheads[2] | S |
| Magazines (print, email) | S,P,D,C |
| Memos[2] | S |
| Newsletters, external (print, email) | S,P,D,C |
| Newsletters, internal (print, email) | S,D,C |
| Online pages housed on third-party servers | S,D,C |
| Podcasts[6] | S,D,C |
| Posters--print | S,P,C |
| PowerPoints, external | S,P,D,C |
| PowerPoints, internal[3] | S,D,C |
| Press releases | S,P |
| Recruiting materials—print | S,P,C |
| Surveys[4] | S,D,C |
| Video conference meetings (recorded or not) | S,P,D,C |
| Video recordings[5] | S,D,C |

**KEY**
**S** = Standard legal description
**P** = Deloitte profile
**D** = Disclaimer
**C** = Copyright

To determine whether a privacy notice or consent language may be required for surveys and studies, please contact Deloitte Global Privacy.

1. Contact Deloitte Global OGC regarding Deloitte Global apps, or the appropriate Deloitte firm OGC teams for Deloitte firm apps.
2. The following sentence must be added below the required language on Deloitte Global letterhead, memos and faxes:
   - *Deloitte Touche Tohmatsu Limited is a private company limited by guarantee incorporated in England & Wales under company number 07271800, and its registered office is 1 New Street Square, London, United Kingdom, EC4A 3HQ.*
3. *Confidential—Internal only* and *© 2026. For information, contact Deloitte Global* must appear on each slide of internal presentations.
4. Deloitte Global surveys that intend to use participants in China, Hong Kong SAR and Macau SAR should consult with Deloitte Global Risk, OGC and Privacy.
5. Before using a video internally or externally, it is important to make sure all required releases/consents have been obtained (including from the subjects in your recording and any third parties whose material is included in the recording). Also see *recordings*. To obtain required release/consent documentation, Deloitte Global people should contact the Deloitte Global Video Studio; Deloitte firm people should contact their local OGC/Risk teams.
6. Language can be included on the website hosting the podcast link rather than having to be "spoken."

# Required review and other processes

**IMPORTANT NOTES**

- All Deloitte firms and their related entities are expected to follow the guidance in the *Deloitte Language and Style Guide*. However, local laws and regulations take precedence over this guidance. Therefore, please consult with your Deloitte firm Legal and/or Risk teams if you have any questions relating to this guide.
- Deloitte firms are expected to implement robust communications review and approval policies and processes—especially for external communications.
- For Deloitte Insights content, the required language and review process
  should adhere to the requirements of the Deloitte firm creating the content.

## Deloitte Global qualified review process

The required review process for Deloitte Global communications is outlined in DTTL Communications Review and Approval Policy (108). All Deloitte Global communications should comply with both Policy 108 and this *Deloitte Global Language and Style Guide and* should be reviewed and approved by (i) a Deloitte Global Qualified Reviewer, (ii) a Deloitte Global senior business sponsor (at Managing Director level or above), and (iii) a subject matter expert (if applicable). Internal team presentations and trainings are not subject to this review and approval process.

The Deloitte Global senior leader business sponsor who reviews and approves the Deloitte Global communication is responsible for the substantive content of the communication and for ensuring that it has been appropriately vetted and represents the views of Deloitte Global.

A subset of communications should also be reviewed by the Deloitte Global Risk review team, including advertisements, press releases, certain CEO communications, the Global Impact Report, and communications addressing legal, regulatory or sensitive matters.

See the Deloitte Global business communications review framework for a more exhaustive list of communications that require Deloitte Global Risk review.

Deloitte Global communications that mention a Deloitte firm client, client products and/or client services should be reviewed and approved by the GLCSP.

Deloitte Global communications that include a Deloitte firm restricted entity name, product or services should be approved by Deloitte Global Independence.

If a Deloitte Global communication has the potential to affect a Deloitte firm or a Deloitte firm client, it should also be reviewed and approved by the Deloitte firm impacted and Deloitte Global Risk. In addition, such Deloitte Global communications should be reviewed and approved by the relevant Deloitte Global Industry group leader, the relevant Deloitte Global Business Risk leader, the relevant Deloitte firms and any other relevant Deloitte Global groups. The senior Deloitte Global Business leader/sponsor is responsible for ensuring that all affected entities, as well as all relevant groups, have reviewed and approved the communication.

- For example, Deloitte Global business communications that discuss the future of human capital needs in the oil and gas industry in the Middle East should be reviewed and approved by the Deloitte Global Oil & Gas Industry group leader, the Deloitte Global Technology & Transformation risk leader, and the Middle East Deloitte firm. These are in addition to the reviews required of all Deloitte Global business communications.

Deloitte Global communications that should be reviewed by the Deloitte Global Risk review team should be submitted via the Deloitte Global Risk Portal.

Any Deloitte firm communication that references Deloitte Global (including the Deloitte Global CEO, Deloitte Global Executive, Deloitte Global Board, Deloitte Global senior leaders or other Deloitte Global individuals), requires submission to the Deloitte Global Risk Portal for review. However, submission to the Deloitte Global Risk Portal is not required if the communication solely references a Deloitte Global report(s), and/or includes an approved quote provided by a Deloitte Global individual or individual(s).

## Deloitte Global qualified reviewers (QRs)

Qualified reviewers (QRs) play a critical role in the review and approval process of Deloitte Global business communications. QRs are responsible for helping to ensure that business communications issued by Deloitte Global:

- Comply with the Deloitte Language and Style Guide and relevant policies;
- Have a clear, confident, and human tone of voice;
- Are factually and grammatically correct;

# Required review and other processes

**IMPORTANT NOTES**

- All Deloitte firms and their related entities are expected to follow the guidance in the *Deloitte Language and Style Guide*. However, local laws and regulations take precedence over this guidance. Therefore, please consult with your Deloitte firm Legal and/or Risk teams if you have any questions relating to this guide.
- Deloitte firms are expected to implement robust communications review and approval policies and processes—especially for external communications.
- For Deloitte Insights content, the required language and review process
  should adhere to the requirements of the Deloitte firm creating the content.

## Deloitte Global qualified reviewers (QRs)

- Are consistent with Deloitte Global strategic priorities and the Deloitte Purpose;
- Validate all citations and sources;
- Do not disclose any client-specific, Deloitte Global, or other confidential information; and
- Do not give rise to potential regulatory or independence concerns.

A Deloitte Global QR is a person who:

- Has appropriate experience (manager level or above);
- Has been nominated by a Deloitte Global senior business leader to review Deloitte Global business communications;
- Has successfully completed the Deloitte Global QR training; and
- Is knowledgeable and maintains a current understanding of the *Deloitte Language and Style Guide* and the DTTL Personnel Policy 108 - Communications Review and Approval.

To become a Deloitte Global QR or if you have questions, contact Lisa Cathcart. To conduct a qualified review, download a copy of the Deloitte Global QR List.

## Deloitte Global Risk "Before you" guides

The Global Risk Review team has produced a series of "Before you" guides providing helpful tips and guidance "before you" proceed with common types of communications activities, such as producing a video, holding an event, conducting a survey, and writing a resume.

## Deloitte Global business reviews

For review of communications at the Deloitte Global business level, please coordinate with the following:

- Audit and Assurance: globalauditbrand@deloitte.com
- Tax and Legal: Via the Tax portal: GT&L Q&R Review portal
- Consulting Services: gcsqualifiedreviewerprogram@deloitte.com and GCS Communications.

## confidentiality

Generally, confidential information (CI) is information not known to the public that relates to our business or that we receive in the course of business from clients, our personnel, or other third parties and should only be used in accordance with the purpose for which it was originally collected or for a purpose that has been authorized by law/regulation. The use of CI outside this scope may require additional approvals, including obtaining written consent from the owner of the CI.

When CI is included in any business communication, it should be protected with safeguards appropriate to the sensitivity of the CI to prevent unauthorized use or disclosure. When in doubt about the use of CI, consult with your local Risk and/or Legal teams.

For additional information, contact Deloitte Global Confidentiality at CCO@deloitte.com or your local Deloitte firm Confidentiality Leader. Also see the Deloitte Policy Manual (DPM) 1630 on Client Confidential Information.

## crisis communications

Deloitte firms should follow their local requirements associated with communications related to crises and sensitive matters and comply with any predefined criteria including, as applicable, PM30, *Claims and events management*, which requires that Deloitte firms notify Deloitte Global OGC and Deloitte Global Risk; this guidance should not supplant that requirement.

Such communications within Deloitte Global should be directed to Deloitte Global Communications. No external communication related to crises and sensitive matters should be undertaken by any Deloitte Global personnel without prior approval from Deloitte Global Communications.

## GenAI-generated content

GenAI is revolutionizing the way people at Deloitte work by accelerating research, drafting, and analysis, but it also introduces risks such as hallucinations, bias, and low-quality content or deliverables. The GenAI Human in the Loop Guidance offers a practical checklist to help Deloitte people responsibly verify and refine deliverables where GenAI has been used. Deloitte firms and global businesses often have their own GenAI guidance and you should ensure you use the appropriate version.

# Required review and other processes

**IMPORTANT NOTES**

- All Deloitte firms and their related entities are expected to follow the guidance in the *Deloitte Language and Style Guide*. However, local laws and regulations take precedence over this guidance. Therefore, please consult with your Deloitte firm Legal and/or Risk teams if you have any questions relating to this guide.
- Deloitte firms are expected to implement robust communications review and approval policies and processes—especially for external communications.
- For Deloitte Insights content, the required language and review process
  should adhere to the requirements of the Deloitte firm creating the content.

## GenAI-generated text

If you have leveraged approved GenAI tools to draft your text, to help mitigate reputational and operational risks and to improve quality and integrity, it should be reviewed, validated and corrected for accuracy and completeness before use. This includes adherence to this Deloitte Language and Style Guide, such as verification of cited references and tone of voice. Furthermore, it is recommended that you indicate the use of GenAI in the creation of the document when sharing with Qualified Reviewers or risk and legal/OGC teams or other reviewers.

## GenAI-generated images

You may use GenAI-generated images provided by Deloitte Global in accordance with the usage guardrails associated with the selected Deloitte Global approved GenAI platform. You may only use GenAI platforms that are approved by Deloitte Global in accordance with the respective usage guardrails.

## Use of GenAI to create audio content (music/sound effects)

GenAI tools must not be used to create music, including background music or sound effects. If there is a business need to use GenAI for music or sound effects, please contact Deloitte Global Risk for guidance or your Deloitte firm Legal and/or Risk team.

## deepfakes

GenAI tools should generally not be used to create deepfakes. A deepfake refers to content that is created by AI that appears real but is not. To be considered a deepfake, four elements must be present:

1. The content must be AI-generated or AI-manipulated.
2. The content must be an image, audio or video content.
3. The subjects depicted in the content resemble existing persons, objects (e.g., artwork, products), places, entities (e.g., a business or government body) or events.
4. The content must appear to be authentic or truthful.

Certain deepfakes, such as using AI to create a cityscape for a well-known city may be permissible.

For further guidance, consult Deloitte Global Risk or your Deloitte firm legal and/or Risk team.

## Agentic AI, Sovereign AI, Physical AI

Always capitalize Agentic AI, Sovereign AI and Physical AI even when not starting a sentence, and include a space between Agentic, Sovereign, Physical and AI.

## Use of GenAI to create materials on matters of public interest (e.g., regulatory guidance, public sector policy documents)

Where GenAI tools are used to create or substantially edit content intended for publication for the purpose of informing the public on matters of public interest, appropriate human oversight and review must be applied. Any such content must be reviewed by an appropriate subject matter specialist prior to publication and published on Deloitte letterhead, including contact details for the Deloitte entity and person(s) responsible for the publication. Consider the Human in the Loop Guidance, as appropriate.

For clarification, consult Deloitte Global Risk or your Deloitte firm legal and/or Risk team before use.

## recordings

Prior to any recording, participants should consent to or be notified of the recording. This notification should provide adequate notice that the recording will take place, clearly state that participation constitutes consent for the recording, and notify the participant that the recording is the property of and may be used by Deloitte. Certain jurisdictions may require that such consent be in writing. Consult with your local Risk and Legal teams for appropriate language. Here is the new guidance for recording and transcribing meetings, which should be adhered to by Deloitte Global professionals.

## social media

See social media on Deloitte Resources or seek guidance from your Deloitte firm with respect to both personal and professional usage of social media.

# How we refer to Deloitte, Deloitte Global, Deloitte firms and Deloitte locations

**IMPORTANT NOTE**
All Deloitte firms and their related entities are expected to follow the guidance in the *Deloitte Language and Style Guide*. However, local laws and regulations take precedence over this guidance. Therefore, please consult with your Deloitte firm Legal and/or Risk teams if you have any questions relating to this guide.

Deloitte is a global organization composed of independent firms throughout the world that provide audit and assurance, tax and legal, and consulting services to select clients. These firms are members of Deloitte Touche Tohmatsu Limited, a UK private company limited by guarantee ("DTTL"). Each Deloitte firm provides services in particular geographic areas and is subject to the laws and professional regulations of the particular jurisdiction or jurisdiction in which it operates. DTTL (also referred to as "Deloitte Global") does not provide services to clients.

## company

Never refer to Deloitte as a *company* or *firm*. Instead, use *network, Deloitte network,* or *Deloitte* alone (see Deloitte). Also acceptable is *professional services network*. If speaking about a Deloitte firm in a specific geography, you can also use *firm* (e.g., the French firm) but never use that term in the singular version if referring to the global network.

The terms *Deloitte*, *Deloitte network*, *network*, *Deloitte organization* or *organization* can be used to refer to Deloitte firms generally, with or without Deloitte Global (see Deloitte).

## Deloitte

*Deloitte* is the preferred term when referring to the entire Deloitte organization. So long as the standard legal description set out in this guide is included and the context is clear; *Deloitte* may be used in a communication to mean:

- The Deloitte brand
- One or more of DTTL, its global network of Deloitte firms, or their related entities (collectively, "Deloitte organization")

Unless necessary (as prescribed in this guide), avoid adding the term *member firm* to any of the above uses (e.g., do not use *Deloitte member firm network*).

The word *organization* or *Deloitte network* may be used to describe the Deloitte network as long as the standard legal description set out in this guide is included on the communication. However, it is not appropriate to use the term *organization* in a formal legal, regulatory or client-facing/engagement documentation. Never use any of the following terms to describe the entire Deloitte network:

- company
- global partnership
- global firm
- the firm
- one firm
- member firm

## Deloitte firm

A *Deloitte firm* is a Deloitte entity in any jurisdiction. All member firms and affiliate firms are considered *Deloitte firms*. Unless it's important for clarity, use *Deloitte* or *Deloitte firm* instead of *member firm* or *member firm affiliate*.

In certain circumstances, such as in the Audit, Tax or Legal businesses, or in legal contracts, proposals, engagement letters, regulatory communications and other official communications, it may be appropriate to refer to one or more specific Deloitte firms by the full legal name of the relevant entity.

Member firms sometimes are referred to internally as *territories* while their affiliates are considered *geographies*. The preferred way to reference a specific Deloitte firm is:

Deloitte + [territory or geography]:

- *Deloitte EMEA*
- *Deloitte UK*
- *Deloitte Bermuda*

Exception: When referring to the US firms, the legal entity names (e.g., *Deloitte Consulting LLP*) should be used. Always lowercase *firm(s)*.

*Deloitte Türkiye* is the correct name of the Deloitte firm in Türkiye. Avoid using the former spelling *Turkey*.

The correct name of the Deloitte US operations in India is *Deloitte US-India Offices*. Internally, *USI* is acceptable as an abbreviation on second reference.

Any initial mention of a Deloitte Global or Deloitte firm professional in an external communication must include a reference to his or her firm or Deloitte Global, as applicable.

- *Jane Smith, Deloitte Global* or *Nancy Johnson, Deloitte Canada* or *John Williams (Deloitte Australia)*.

For a list of Deloitte firms, contact Deloitte Global OGC. Also see member firm and member firm affiliate.

# How we refer to Deloitte, Deloitte Global, Deloitte firms and Deloitte locations

**IMPORTANT NOTE**
All Deloitte firms and their related entities are expected to follow the guidance in the *Deloitte Language and Style Guide*. However, local laws and regulations take precedence over this guidance. Therefore, please consult with your Deloitte firm Legal and/or Risk teams if you have any questions relating to this guide.

## Deloitte Global, Deloitte Touche Tohmatsu Limited, DTTL

Deloitte Touche Tohmatsu Limited (also referred to as *Deloitte Global*) is a private company limited by guarantee incorporated in England and Wales.

Generally speaking, *Deloitte Global* is the preferred term over *Deloitte Touche Tohmatsu Limited* or *DTTL*. Exceptions are appropriate in certain circumstances, including in legal, regulatory or other official communications.

- When using *Deloitte Global* in external communications, be sure to include the standard legal description.
- Always use initial caps for *Deloitte Global*.

Deloitte Global does not provide services to clients. Never say or imply that it does.

- Refer to *Deloitte clients*. Never say *Deloitte Global clients*.
  - Refer to global (lowercase) clients of Deloitte when specifying clients that operate globally. Do not refer to Deloitte global (lowercase) clients as it may be confused with Deloitte Global (uppercase) clients, which is incorrect as Deloitte Global does not provide services to clients.
- Refer to *aggregate Deloitte firm revenue*, not *Deloitte Global revenue*.

## Deloitte Heritage – Age of Deloitte

When referencing Deloitte's age one should use *180+* or *more than 180 years* as the reference. (e.g., *For more than 180 years, Deloitte has…* or *Over the past 180+ years, Deloitte has…*).

## Deloitte logo

The Deloitte logo is the organization's most valued, iconic brand asset and must be treated with proper care. The logo is placed for maximum clarity and consistency across all touchpoints. For information on proper placement on Deloitte materials, click here.

In digital mediums, specifically social media, the Deloitte favicon is used in lieu of the logo. It must be treated with care like the Deloitte logo. For more information on the favicon, click here.

The Deloitte logo is a registered trademark. Use of the Deloitte logo by external third parties should be permitted only in limited circumstances and be preapproved by your local Deloitte firm Brand, Risk or Legal teams, Deloitte Global Brand, and Deloitte Global OGC or Deloitte Global Risk. A written agreement with the external third party is required.

## firm (in reference to Deloitte)

Neither Deloitte Global nor the Deloitte network should ever be referred to as a *firm* in writing or speaking.

## locations (where Deloitte does business)

Take care when referencing the names of countries and regions where Deloitte does business. Deloitte.com includes a list of global office locations.

The phrases *countries where Deloitte does business* or *Deloitte operates in X countries* are not appropriate. Instead, use the following options, where applicable: *countries and territories; countries and regions; locations; jurisdictions;* or *geographies*.

When referencing geographies listed in the table that follows, use only the recommended terminology. If you are unsure how to reference a location that's not included on Deloitte.com or the table, contact the Deloitte firm risk leader in that geography for guidance.

| Geography | Recommended terminology |
|---|---|
| China | Use *China* when referring to the combined jurisdictions of China Mainland, Hong Kong SAR and Macau SAR. Note: *SAR* stands for Special Administrative Region. |
| Hong Kong SAR | Do not use *Hong Kong* alone. Instead, use *Hong Kong SAR* or *Hong Kong SAR, China* (as a jurisdiction, part of China). Note: *SAR* stands for Special Administrative Region. |
| Kosovo | It is permissible to reference *Kosovo*. Please adhere to guidance regarding the use of *regions*, *locations*, *jurisdictions* or *geographies* rather than using the term *country* on its own. |
| Macau SAR | Do not use *Macau* alone. Instead, use *Macau SAR* or *Macau SAR, China* (as a jurisdiction, part of China). Note: *SAR* stands for Special Administrative Region. |
| Palestinian Territories | It is permissible to reference *Palestinian Territories*. Do not use *Palestinian Ruled Territories* or *Occupied Palestinian Territories*. Please adhere to guidance regarding the use of *regions*, *locations*, *jurisdictions* or *geographies* rather than using the term *country* on its own. |
| Taiwan (China) | For internal use, e.g., meeting registrations and name badges, refer to *Taiwan*.<br>For external use, e.g., D.com, refer to *Taiwan (China)*.<br>Both internally and externally, Taiwan should be referred to as a jurisdiction or territory, not as a country.<br>The Deloitte Asia Pacific participating firm in Taiwan can be referred to internally and externally as *Deloitte Taiwan*. Please note, *Deloitte Taiwan* should only be used to reference the participating firm itself, e.g., "Deloitte Taiwan recently won a large technology engagement." |
| Türkiye | When referring to the country, its preferred naming, Türkiye, should be used instead of Turkey. |

# How we refer to Deloitte, Deloitte Global, Deloitte firms and Deloitte locations

**IMPORTANT NOTE**
All Deloitte firms and their related entities are expected to follow the guidance in the *Deloitte Language and Style Guide*. However, local laws and regulations take precedence over this guidance. Therefore, please consult with your Deloitte firm Legal and/or Risk teams if you have any questions relating to this guide.

## maps and flags

Be mindful when using maps or flags to indicate where Deloitte firms are located or serve clients, as there are sensitivities around these in some regions. Please consult with Deloitte Global Risk or your Deloitte firm Risk leader for guidance on your specific use.

## member firm

*Member firm* refers to an entity that signed membership documentation with Deloitte Global. All *member firms* are considered *Deloitte firms*, but not all *Deloitte firms* are *member firms*.

Try to limit the use of *member firm* to references that specifically include only those firms that have membership agreements with DTTL.

- *The committee included representation from all 14 Deloitte member firms.*
- *Deloitte member firms have hundreds of affiliates around the world.*

Unless it's important for clarity, use *Deloitte* or *Deloitte firm* instead of *member firm*, especially in external communications. For example, rather than *Deloitte member firm locations* or *Deloitte member firm people*, simply use *Deloitte firm locations* or *Deloitte people*.

- Exception: When referring to member firm partners generally, you should say *Deloitte member firm partners*. For more information, see partner.

When referring to Deloitte revenue, use the term *Deloitte aggregate member firm revenue* or *aggregate Deloitte firm revenue* on first reference. In subsequent references, the phrase *Deloitte revenue* may be used. For more information, see metrics.

The preferred way to reference a specific member firm is:

Deloitte + [territory]:

- *Deloitte EMEA*
- *Deloitte Canada*
- *Deloitte Asia Pacific*

**Always lowercase *member firm(s)* unless it begins a sentence, then capitalize *member* only.**

Note that the Deloitte CIS member firm will now be referred to as Deloitte DKU, effective 1 June 2023. The new member firm name distances the Deloitte brand from affiliation with Russia, more accurately represents the current geographic footprint and enables Deloitte DKU to position itself regionally where it retains territorial rights. Deloitte DKU consists of two geographies: Kazakhstan and Uzbekistan. Effective 2 January 2024, Deloitte Ukraine, which was formerly part of Deloitte DKU, is now part of the Deloitte Central Europe Firm, a shareholder of the DCE member firm. Please note: While the member firm will be referred to as Deloitte DKU, the name of the member firm legal entity has not changed.

For certain member firms, such as the US, and in certain types of communications, it may be necessary to use the full legal name of an entity. Questions relating to this should be addressed to your member firm Legal and/or Risk teams.

Also see Deloitte firm and member firm affiliate.

## member firm affiliate

*Member firm affiliates* are those entities that comprise Deloitte member firms. All affiliates are considered *Deloitte firms*.

Unless it's important for clarity, use *Deloitte* or *Deloitte firm* instead of *Deloitte member firm affiliate*. Do not refer to affiliates as *member firms* or *members of Deloitte Global* (e.g., do not say *the Swiss member firm* as Deloitte Switzerland is an affiliate of Deloitte North and South Europe, which is the member firm). Any questions relating to how to identify affiliates should be referred to your member firm Legal and/or Risk teams.

Member firm affiliates sometimes are referred to internally as *geographies*. In general, affiliates of a member firm should be identified as *Deloitte + [geography]:*

- *Deloitte Bermuda*
- *Deloitte Italy*

Also see Deloitte firm and member firm.

# How we refer to Deloitte people and groups

**IMPORTANT NOTE**
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## Audit & Assurance

The Deloitte business formerly known simply as *Audit* is now called *Audit & Assurance*. Always use initial caps when referencing the proper name of the Deloitte business and use an ampersand as that's included in the proper name. Generic references to *audit* and *assurance* should be lowercase.

- *Jean-Marc Mickeler is the Audit & Assurance business leader for Deloitte Global.*
- *Regulators seek continuous improvement in audit quality and assurance.*

## businesses

*Businesses* is how we refer to Deloitte's primary storefronts of Audit & Assurance; Tax & Legal; Strategy, Risk & Transactions; and Technology & Transformation.

Capitalize if used as a proper name, but lowercase if the reference is generic.

- *Deloitte Consulting LLP provides consulting services in the US.*

## Deloitte Global Executive

The Deloitte Global Executive, composed of leaders from Deloitte Global and select Deloitte firms across the global network, is responsible for embedding Deloitte's Purpose and advancing its aspiration and strategic priorities.

Capitalize *Deloitte Global Executive* (a proper name) and use the entire name on first reference. *The Executive* is acceptable on subsequent references; capitalize *Executive*, but not *the,* unless it's starting a sentence.

- *The Deloitte Global Executive, which meets approximately eight times during the year, sets policies and champions initiatives that help the network make an impact that matters for Deloitte firm clients, Deloitte people, communities and other stakeholders. Deloitte Global CEO Joe Ucuzoglu leads and manages the Executive.*

## Deloitte Global roles

In both external and internal communications, member firm individuals who identify themselves as having a Deloitte Global role should ensure that the appropriate documentation formalizing their Deloitte Global role is in place and up-to-date. For the avoidance of doubt, member firm individuals may not have or identify themselves in external or internal communications as having a Deloitte Global role (for instance, by using a Deloitte Global title) without such documentation. If you have any questions regarding the existence or up-to-date status of applicable documentation for a Deloitte Global role, please log a My Support Global ticket for Deloitte Global Mobility at Home - My Support Global (service-now.com).

## enabling areas

Areas that support the Deloitte network and its businesses are considered *enabling areas*. Only capitalize *enabling* if it's the first word of a sentence. It can be abbreviated *EAs* after being spelled out in the first instance.

Examples include, but are not limited to: Clients & Industries, Innovation, Talent, Technology, Finance, Communications, Brand, and Analyst Relations.

Capitalize if used as a proper name, but lowercase if the reference is generic.

- *The Deloitte Global Office of the General Counsel (OGC) provides legal guidance to Deloitte Global.*
- *The Deloitte Canada Talent team recruits talent for the firm.*

Also see businesses and Deloitte firm.

## global lead client service partner (GLCSP)

Certain clients are served by *global lead client service partners* (GLCSPs).

Spell out on first use, followed by the abbreviation in parentheses. The abbreviation may be used in subsequent references.

When spelled out, lowercase if used generally and not as part of someone's title; only capitalize *global* if the phrase is used to begin a sentence.

- *The global lead client service partner (GLCSP) is based in London.*
- *Global lead client service partners have significant responsibilities.*

# How we refer to Deloitte people and groups

**IMPORTANT NOTE**
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## GLCSP (continued)

Spell out and use initial caps when used as a title before a GLCSP's name, but lowercase if used after the name. Always include the relevant Deloitte firm, or affiliate thereof, as part of the identification.

- *Global Lead Client Service Partner Megan Brown, Deloitte Australia, conducted the meeting.*
- *Megan Brown, global lead client service partner from Deloitte Australia, conducted the meeting.*

Do not say Deloitte Global Lead Client Service Partner (GLCSP) because that suggests Deloitte Global has partners or is a partnership.

Note: This is an exception to the use of the word partner. Also see lead client service partner (LCSP).

## industry groups

Deloitte has moved from an industry/sector taxonomy structure of six industries and 21 sectors. The six industries and sectors for each are as follows:

- *Technology, Media & Telecom (Telecom, Media & Entertainment; Technology)*
- *Consumer (Consumer Products; Retail, Wholesale & Distribution; Automotive; Transportation, Hospitality & Services)*
- *Energy, Resources & Industrials (Industrial Products & Construction; Mining & Metals; Energy & Chemicals; Power, Utilities & Renewables)*
- *Financial Services (Banking & Capital Markets; Insurance; Investment Management; Real Estate)*
- *Life Sciences & Health Care (Health Care; Life Sciences)*
- *Government & Public Services (Central Government; Defense, Security & Justice; Health & Human Services; Infrastructure, Transport & Regional Government)*

Capitalize industry and sector names, including the word *industry* (but not the word *group*)—and use ampersands—when they refer to Deloitte industry groups by name. Also, *Global* should precede formal industry names and always be capitalized. Lowercase industries and sectors and avoid ampersands in generic references.

- *He recently became the Deloitte Global Life Sciences & Health Care Industry group leader.*
- *The technology, media and entertainment, and telecommunications ecosystem remains as fascinating as ever.*
- *Our Mining & Metals sector professionals have a comprehensive grasp of the silver mining industry.*

*Technology, Media & Telecom (TMT)*; *Energy, Resources & Industrials (ERI)*; *Life Sciences & Health Care (LSHC)*; and *Government & Public Services (GPS)* may be abbreviated on second and subsequent references as long as they are spelled out on first use, followed by the abbreviation in parentheses. Do not abbreviate *Consumer*, *Financial Services* or any of the sector names.

Always spell out *Global*, even when abbreviating industry names.

- *The Deloitte Global TMT Industry group will issue its report next month.*

Refer to Deloitte Global *groups* rather than *practices*.

- *The Deloitte Global TMT Industry group is made up of individual Deloitte firm TMT practices.*

## lead client service partner (LCSP)

Spell out on first use, followed by the abbreviation in parentheses. The abbreviation may be used in subsequent references.

When spelled out, lowercase if used generally and not as part of someone's title; capitalize only *Lead* if the phrase is used to begin a sentence.

- *The lead client service partner (LCSP) is based in Detroit.*
- *Lead client service partners have significant responsibilities.*

Spell out and use initial caps when used as a title before an LCSP's name, but lowercase if used after the name. Always include the relevant Deloitte firm as part of the identification.

- *Lead Client Service Partner Ralph Smith, Deloitte Canada, conducted the meeting.*
- *Ralph Smith, lead client service partner from Deloitte Canada, conducted the meeting.*

Note: This is an exception to the use of the word partner. Also see global lead client service partner (GLCSP).

# How we refer to Deloitte people and groups

**IMPORTANT NOTE**
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## offering portfolios

*Offering portfolios* describes the offerings that sit inside each of Deloitte's primary businesses (e.g., Audit, Assurance, Tax, Global Employer Services, Strategy & Transactions, Cyber, etc.).

## Operate services vs. Operate

When writing about Deloitte's Operate services/capabilities in external content, the first reference should be Operate services versus Operate. Subsequent references in the same piece can use Operate. Do not refer to Operate as "Deloitte Operate".

## partner

The word *partner* has specific legal meaning and could imply a legal partnership between two or more entities or persons. Do not use *partner*, *partnering* or *partnership* to describe relationships between Deloitte firms or between people associated with different Deloitte firms.

Exception: The terms *lead client service partner* and *global lead client service partner* are acceptable.

- Do not say *the US and Canadian Deloitte firms are partners in a new initiative*.

Always lowercase *partner* unless it's beginning a sentence.

Use *Deloitte [country] partners*, *Deloitte leaders* or *Deloitte member firm partners*. The latter is an exception where it's recommended to use *member firm* instead of *Deloitte* or *Deloitte firm*.

- Do not say *Deloitte partners, Deloitte firm partners* or *Deloitte Global partners*. These terms may incorrectly imply that Deloitte Global or the Deloitte network are partnerships.

Do not use the phrase *global partnership* in reference to Deloitte or any entity within the Deloitte network.

Avoid using *partner*, *partnering* or *partnership* when referring to clients and alliances.

- Do not say *Deloitte Japan is partnering with the company*.
- Alternatives for relationship clients include *teamed with*, *in collaboration with, supported by* or *in alliance with*. For example, say *Deloitte Australia is collaborating with the company*. However, this language may not be appropriate for audit clients.

Questions relating to the use of the terms *partner*, *principal* or the applicable equivalent should be addressed to your Deloitte firm's Risk or Legal teams.

## practices

*Practices* reside within the Deloitte firms (and not Deloitte Global):

- *Deloitte France's Financial Services practice serves clients in the banking and insurance industries*.
- *Deloitte practices serve clients in the banking and insurance industries*.

Deloitte Global does not have practices because it has no clients. Deloitte Global Industry groups are made up of individual Deloitte firm practices.

## principal (vs. partner)

Always lowercase *principal* unless it's beginning a sentence.

For correct usage, refer to local requirements. For example, in the US, *partner* should be used only by licensed CPA owners who have been assigned to one of the US firms that is a licensed public accounting firm, while *principal* should be used by all other owners.

Questions relating to the use of the terms *partner*, *principal* or the applicable equivalent should be addressed to your Deloitte firm's Risk or Legal teams.

## professionals, practitioners

When referring to Deloitte people, the preferred terms are *professional* and *practitioner*. For client-facing individuals, the preferred term is *practitioner*. For nonclient facing individuals, the preferred term is *professional*. Both terms are subject to local market, legal or regulatory requirements.

Collectively, *Deloitte people* is acceptable when referring to groups that include both professionals and practitioners.

# How we refer to Deloitte people and groups

**IMPORTANT NOTE**
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## regions

Deloitte member firms are grouped into three regions: Americas, Asia Pacific (AP), and Europe/Middle East/Africa (EMEA). Use initial caps for region names but always lowercase the word *region*.

- *The Americas region has five Deloitte firms.*

On first reference, spell out Asia Pacific (AP) and Europe/Middle East/Africa (EMEA), followed by abbreviations in parentheses. Abbreviations may be used in subsequent references.

## titles, leadership titles

Capitalize titles that appear before a person's name, but lowercase titles that appear after a person's name and titles not used with a name.

*Chief executive officer* may be abbreviated *CEO* on first reference. All other titles should be spelled out. If appropriate, titles may be abbreviated parenthetically on first reference and abbreviated in later references.

Format the titles of leaders of Deloitte firms and affiliates as follows: *[Name], CEO, Deloitte [Territory or Geography].*

- *John Smith, CEO, Deloitte North and South Europe*
- *Jane Smith, CEO, Deloitte Belgium*

Format the titles of business and industry leaders of Deloitte firms as follows: *[Name], partner (or principal), [Business/Industry], Deloitte [Geography].* For certain Deloitte firms, such as the US, it may be necessary to use the full legal name of the entity. Questions relating to this should be addressed to your Deloitte firm Legal and/or Risk teams.

- *Jane Smith, partner, Consulting Services, Deloitte Canada*
- *John Smith, Deloitte Global Consulting Services GPS leader*
- *Jane Smith, Consulting Services leader, Deloitte Global*

***Leaders with both Deloitte Global and Deloitte firm roles***

If a leader has both Deloitte Global and Deloitte firm roles, reference only the entity that is relevant in that particular communication (except in biographies, where both roles are acceptable). Such dual-hatted Deloitte Global leaders should use separate e-mail signatures depending on the purpose and audience of the email.

For any communication with clients regarding the provision of services or that relates to a client engagement, it is imperative to use your Deloitte firm title signature. (Deloitte Global cannot provide services to clients.)

For communications related to your Deloitte Global role, the below email signature or title format should be used.

Deloitte Global email signature:

Format: *[Name], Global [Business] [Business/Industry area] leader, Deloitte Touche Tohmatsu Limited.*

- *Jane Smith, Global Consulting Quality, Risk & Infrastructure leader, Deloitte Touche Tohmatsu Limited*

Deloitte Global communication title:

A simpler format is used in communications (such as articles, reports, and press releases) to help users quickly understand the leader's role.

Format: *[Name], Deloitte Global [Business] [Business/Industry area] leader.*

- *John Smith, Deloitte Global Consulting Services GPS leader*

Where there is a reference to Deloitte Global, the standard legal description as set out in the *Deloitte Language and Style Guide* should be included.

In Deloitte.com people profiles, where the standard legal description is visible, a simpler format also helps readers more easily understand the leader's role.

Format: *[Name], [Business/Industry area] leader, Deloitte Global*

- *Jane Smith, Consulting Services leader, Deloitte Global*

For additional guidance, refer to Deloitte Global: Before you write a resume or bio.

# How we refer to Deloitte clients and third parties

**IMPORTANT NOTE**
All Deloitte firms and their related entities are expected to follow the guidance in the *Deloitte Language and Style Guide*. However, local laws and regulations take precedence over this guidance. Therefore, please consult with your Deloitte firm Legal and/or Risk teams if you have any questions relating to this guide.

## clients/customers

Use *clients*, not *customers,* when referring to entities that contract for Deloitte business services.

Use *Deloitte clients* or *our clients*, provided it's clear from the context that we are talking about a specific Deloitte firm(s) or the Deloitte network and not Deloitte Global.

Exception: In certain circumstances—such as in the audit, tax or legal spaces; legal contracts, proposals or engagement letters; regulatory communications; or other official communications—it may be appropriate to specify which Deloitte firm(s) serves a client.

Deloitte Global does not have clients.

## client names and logos (use of)

Most client engagement agreements address whether a client's name may be used in internal or external Deloitte communications. Typically, but not always, mentioning a client by name is contractually prohibited in external communications; use of client names may be more lenient in internal communications within the engagement team firm(s).

In each instance, obtain G/LCSP approval not only for use of a client name, but also for the specific context in which a client name is being used. Prior to using a client's name and/or logo, written permission should be received in writing from the G/LSCP. A client's permission is required for use of the client's logo and the G/LCSP can assist in obtaining this. For additional guidance see "Before you write a client story"

When client information is described anonymously, GLCSP approval is still necessary.

GLCSP consent is required for both confidential and nonconfidential use of client information. In the absence of a GLCSP, consult the relevant Deloitte Global Industry leader.

Permission to use the client's name or logo should be received in writing from the GLCSP. Communications that refer to an attest client or an attest client's business, products or services must be reviewed by Deloitte Global Independence or the Deloitte firm's independence function, in addition to the GLCSP.

It is not necessary to obtain GLCSP approval for properly cited sources. However, if a Deloitte external publication references a Deloitte client that is a restricted entity, a business relationship restricted entity, or a watchlist entity, even though the source is properly cited, GLCSP approval would be required.

## endorsements

In general, avoid endorsements (either explicit or implicit) or testimonials of any third parties or their products or services, including vendors, subcontractors, or political party affiliations, alliance entities, Deloitte firm clients, authors of publications, or in the context of a sponsorship relationship. Allowing a third party, including a client, to use the Deloitte logo can also be seen as an implicit endorsement of the third party.

Endorsements can create challenges for a number of reasons, including:

- Auditor independence issues;
- Perception that Deloitte is responsible for the goods or services of the third party; and
- Business conflicts with other Deloitte firm clients or vendors who are competitors of the endorsed third party.
- Provides a false impression that Deloitte favors or supports a specific political ideology.

If a senior Deloitte leader deems it appropriate to provide an endorsement for business reasons, that leader should discuss the facts and circumstances with Deloitte Global OGC and Risk, as well as the appropriate Deloitte firm Legal and Risk group, before endorsing the third party.

If an endorsement involves a restricted entity, the relevant facts and circumstances should also be discussed with Deloitte Global Independence or the Deloitte firm's independence function.

# How we refer to Deloitte clients and third parties

**IMPORTANT NOTE**
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## Global Crown Jewel

The Global Crown Jewel (GCJ) client program is dedicated to delivering a distinctive and consistent client experience for clients that are material, complex and iconic. These clients generally are members of the Fortune Global 500 but can also be government organizations or smaller companies currently achieving hyper growth.

The phrase *Global Crown Jewel(s)* should be spelled out on first use using initial caps, followed by the abbreviation in parentheses. The abbreviation may be used in subsequent references.

Do not say *Deloitte Global Crown Jewel (GCJ) clients* because that suggests Deloitte Global has clients. Rather, say *Deloitte Crown Jewel clients*, *global Deloitte Crown Jewel clients* or just *Crown Jewel clients*.

Note: *Global Crown Jewel* is an internal designation; this program should not be mentioned in external communications. Prior to using this messaging internally or with your clients, please obtain approval from your local member firm legal and risk organizations in compliance with your local member firm approval process.

*Always capitalize Growth Platforms, Alliances, Ecosystems and Technology Relationships*

## Global Growth Platforms

Global Growth Platforms have a significant impact on our business, our role in the market, our influence, and our competitive advantage. Global Growth Platforms include Ecosystems, Alliances, and Technology Relationships.

## Ecosystems

Ecosystems are an organizing construct for multi-party strategic relationships in which some or all parties are interdependent. Each party must have a clear path to value, with monetization often serving as a shared value driver. The ecosystem structure must also avoid foundational conflicts of interest among participating parties, including parties that may compete in other contexts.

## Alliances

Alliances are a type of Marketplace Business Relationship. In an Alliance, Deloitte and a single third party combine their respective areas of expertise to address complex issues that no single organization can solve alone.

## Technology Relationships

Technology Relationships refer to Deloitte's relationships with SEC Restricted Entities in connection with Deloitte services involving those entities' products and solutions. These relationships are limited to permissible interactions and are primarily focused on developing and maintaining Deloitte's delivery capabilities. A Technology Relationship is not a Marketplace Business Relationship and does not include arrangements such as Alliances, teaming, prime-subcontracting, or collaboration on eminence-building, which may be impermissible between Deloitte and SEC Restricted Entities.

## logos

See Deloitte logo.

## third-party materials

Third-party logos, trademarks, music, photos, ideas, information, charts/tables, etc. need prior written permission from the third-party owner of the material before they can be reproduced in any communication. Consult your local Legal and/or Risk team for specific guidance on the use of these materials. If creating materials to support a client pursuit using a third party's intellectual property, follow the guiding principles found here.

# How we refer to global Deloitte initiatives

**IMPORTANT NOTE**
All Deloitte firms and their related entities are expected to follow the guidance in the *Deloitte Language and Style Guide*. However, local laws and regulations take precedence over this guidance. Therefore, please consult with your Deloitte firm Legal and/or Risk teams if you have any questions relating to this guide.

## Advise-Implement-Operate (A-I-O)

Spell out on first use using initial caps, followed by the abbreviation in parentheses. The abbreviation may be used in subsequent references.

## brand positioning

Deloitte's brand positioning, *Progress with purpose through integrity and impact*, expresses what we deliver: progress that is purposeful and beneficial. It is an internal concept only that reminds us what good progress looks like. We don't use this positioning phrase externally as a headline or communications theme. For communications both internal and external, we have expressed the positioning in our new tagline, *Together makes progress*, and this is the phrase and the idea we use across communications. For more information about Deloitte's brand positioning and tagline and how to use them, click here.

## centers of excellence (COEs)

Centers of excellence (COEs) are generally virtual pools of specialists with roles in pursuits, delivery support or educational support, which are available to assist Deloitte firms. Some COEs do not provide services to clients, while other COEs may do so. If a specialist from a COE provides client service on behalf of a Deloitte firm, such specialist will be assigned to that Deloitte firm. COEs may be temporary, helping Deloitte firms build capabilities over time and disbanding, when necessary, scale is achieved. Or they may be permanent, ongoing sources of support for Deloitte firms.

Lowercase, unless it is part of a proper name. It can be abbreviated *COE/COEs* after being spelled out in the first instance.

- *Deloitte leverages the full global scale of its network through global client leadership, centers of excellence (COEs) and global delivery centers. In COEs, experienced professionals serve in their local markets but are also deployable (through assignment arrangements) to pursue and serve other markets.*

## Deloitte's Purpose

Deloitte people are motivated by a Purpose: to make an impact that matters – for our clients, our people, and society. Our Purpose is the reason for our existence and underpins our business strategy and decision-making.

The Deloitte Purpose Leader Guidebook contains our Purpose narrative that describes how Deloitte makes an impact that matters. The narrative is for internal use and may be used in part or in whole in crafting messages, capturing stories and bringing our Purpose to life. Our Purpose narrative is as follows:

Why we exist

Our Purpose is to make an impact that matters for our clients, our people, and society

What matters

We do this by driving progress toward a more inclusive, sustainable, trustworthy, and prosperous future.

How we make progress

We drive progress through the services we provide, developing our people, the societal investments we make, and collaborations with our ecosystems.

Refer to the Deloitte Purpose Leader Guidebook for the full narrative and guidance on the use in local contexts.

## Deloitte University

Deloitte University (DU) facilities are where learning and culture intersect to grow the world's best leaders across our global network. DU comes to life through three interconnected facets: the world-class DU curriculum, state-of-the-art DU facilities, and a distinct DU experience. There are seven branded DU learning facilities. Their full-length names are:

- Deloitte University North (Toronto, Canada)
- Deloitte University, The Leadership Center (Westlake, Texas, US)
- DU: The Leadership Center in India (Hyderabad, India)
- Deloitte University EMEA (Paris, France)
- Deloitte University EMEA (La Hulpe, Belgium, and Chantilly, France)
- Deloitte University Asia Pacific (Sentosa Island, Singapore)
- Deloitte University Asia Pacific China (Beijing, China)
- Deloitte University, D.Líderes (Mexico City, Mexico)

Locations generally are described as *sites* or *facilities*. Avoid describing them as *campuses unless you are referencing the various campus locations as part of DU AP*.

In press releases and other official communications, format as [the site's
full-length name] in [location] on first reference.

- *Deloitte University Asia Pacific in Sentosa Island, Singapore*

In internal messages and scripts, the abbreviated version *Deloitte University in [location]* may be used. In addition, the terms DU EMEA and DU AP may be used internally.

For more information, visit the DU site.

# How we refer to global Deloitte initiatives

**IMPORTANT NOTE**
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## Global Delivery Network (GDN)

One of the key priorities in Deloitte's strategy is to leverage and harness the power of our global network to scale delivery consistently. The Global Delivery Network (GDN) represents the collective global, regional, and local centers as a coordinated delivery model with each layer playing a critical role. This network combines efficiency, specialized capabilities, and proximity to client needs to deliver high-quality, cost-effective, and consistent outcomes.

- Global delivery center (GDC) provide scalable, cost-effective delivery and specialized capabilities through standardized methods, tools, and global talent
- Regional delivery centers (RDCs) align to geographic markets, offering flexibility and expertise tailored to regional and regulatory environments
- Local delivery centers (LDCs) operate within member firms or client markets, providing on-the-ground insight and client engagement
- Specialty delivery centers (SpC) offer deep expertise in niche or highly specialized capabilities, supporting differentiated client needs

Together, GDN operates as an integrated ecosystem to provide seamless collaboration across the network to drive value for our clients globally.

Style Guidance:

- Capitalize "Global Delivery Network (GDN)" on first reference; use GDN thereafter
- Use lowercase global, regional, local, or specialty delivery centers unless at the start of a sentence
- Spell out each term on first use with abbreviation in parenthesis (GDN, GDCs, RDCs, LDCs, SpC); abbreviations only may be used thereafter
- Avoid introducing alternative terminology for delivery layers (e.g., hubs, centers of excellence) when referring to GDN or its centers
- Avoid referring to global delivery centers in isolation when describing the broader delivery network; instead, reference the Global Delivery Network (GDN)
- Avoid using "Deloitte global delivery centers" as it may be misinterpreted to mean DTTL

## Global Principles of Business Conduct (Global Code)

The Deloitte Global Code outlines the commitments we all make as Deloitte people. It defines what we mean by acting with integrity and conveys the behaviors we expect from our leaders and people.

These are not aspirations, but 12 principles that we all commit to today and every day: integrity; quality; professional behavior; objectivity; competence; fair business practices; confidentiality, privacy and data protection; respect, inclusion and fair treatments; professional development and support; anti-corruption; responsible supply chain; and social responsibility.

The Integrity Imperative is a program designed to help amplify our Global Code across the network.

## *Impact* Day

*Impact* Day activities, hosted by Deloitte offices around the world, offer our people opportunities to dedicate a full day to volunteering. It has been part of Deloitte's culture since 2000.

*Impact* Day is two words, both capitalized with *Impact* italicized.

- *Impact* Day provides an opportunity for Deloitte people to support local nonprofits by mentoring young people, teaching skill-building seminars for nonprofit leaders, leading environmental clean-up projects, and similar activities.

## *Impact* Every Day

*Impact* Every Day was introduced in 2020 as a refreshed way to articulate and recognize Deloitte's year-round commitment to communities—not just on *Impact* Day, but every day.

It's written as three words (not *Impact* Everyday), with each word capitalized and *Impact* italicized.

- Through *Impact* Every Day, Deloitte provides volunteering and pro bono opportunities for our people on an ongoing basis, which enables long-term, strategic impact in the communities where we live and work.

# How we refer to global Deloitte initiatives

**IMPORTANT NOTE**
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## *IndustryAdvantage™*

is Deloitte's approach to bringing industry depth, sector insight, and specialized capabilities together to help Deloitte firm clients address some of their most complex challenges and opportunities.

IndustryAdvantage is written as a single compound word with no space between Industry and Advantage. Use initial caps.

On first reference, include the trademark symbol: IndustryAdvantage™.

On subsequent references, omit the trademark symbol: IndustryAdvantage.

Do not place IndustryAdvantage in quotation marks.

- Through IndustryAdvantage™, Deloitte practitioners bring together deep industry knowledge and cross business capabilities to deliver differentiated client outcomes.
- IndustryAdvantage enables Deloitte teams to apply sector-specific insight at scale across the network.

## multidisciplinary model (MDM)

One of the key elements of the Deloitte strategy is to operate as a multidisciplinary model. Deloitte's multidisciplinary model, which encompasses the full range of our current services, creates significant benefits for clients and for the global network, including maximizing revenue and cost synergies.

*Multidisciplinary model* can be spelled out consistently throughout a document. If referenced multiple times in the same document, the initial reference should be spelled out, and subsequent mentions can be abbreviated *MDM*. There is no hyphen in *multidisciplinary*; it is a compound word. Only capitalize *multidisciplinary* when it is the first word in a sentence.

## regional delivery centers (RDCs)

One of the key elements in the global Deloitte strategy is to act with full global scale through global client leadership, centers of excellence, and global and regional delivery centers. Regional delivery centers offer Deloitte firms cost-effective subject-matter specialists to support delivery (through assignment arrangements).

Capitalize *regional* only if it's the first word of a sentence. No other words should be capitalized when spelled out. It can be abbreviated as *RDC/RDCs* after being spelled out in the first instance.

- *Regional delivery centers (RDCs) will bring cost advantages and specialists to Deloitte firms (through assignment arrangements) to help improve profitability, breadth of services, consistency and quality. RDCs focus on delivery, not selling, through changes in the current operating model and standardized methods and tools.*

## Shared Values

Deloitte's *Shared Values* are:

- Lead the way
- Serve with integrity
- Take care of each other
- Foster inclusion
- Collaborate for measurable impact

*Shared Values* should be initial capped. A specific Shared Value is not capitalized when used in a sentence.

- *The Shared Value of "serve with integrity" speaks to our commitment to always do the right thing.*

# How we refer to global Deloitte initiatives

**IMPORTANT NOTE**
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## tone of voice

All Deloitte communications should have a *confident, clear* and *human* tone of voice:

**Confident**

- Have a point of view
- State it directly and clearly
- Say what action you will take/the audience should take

**Clear**

- Use simple, everyday words
- Keep it short and to the point
- Set out a logical structure

**Human**

- Use first and second person (instead of third) whenever possible
- Use a relaxed conversational tone and sound natural (like a person wrote it)
- Avoid jargon

See tone of voice training materials that can help create confident, clear and human communications.

## TOP partnership

Deloitte is embarking on a decade-long partnership with the International Olympic Committee (IOC). Our TOP (The Olympic Partner) partnership is the highest echelon of Olympic sponsorship with rights extending to the IOC, IPC, all upcoming Olympic & Paralympic Games and Youth Olympic Games through 2032 and the 206 NOCs (post acquisition by the IOC). For information on how to activate, contact the Global Brand team.

When referring to the *TOP partnership*, always capitalize *TOP* and lowercase *partnership*. Never use any entities other than Deloitte (e.g., Deloitte Digital, Deloitte Consulting Services, etc.) in reference to this relationship.

The term *Olympic* is only approved within official IOC terminology and cannot be used as a generic adjective.

Always refer to event names in full. For example, *Olympic Games [Host City] [Year]* or *[Host City] [Year] Paralympic Games*. For each subsequent reference within a single material after a full event reference, you can use a shortened *[Host City + Year]* reference.

## *Together makes progress*

Deloitte's tagline *Together makes progress* should always be written in sentence case and should be italicized when possible.

## undisputed leader/leadership

*Undisputed leadership* is an aspirational concept; at Deloitte, it results from growing our business, transforming our network and protecting our brand. The phrase should be used only in reference to Deloitte's official strategic aspiration. Because *leader/leadership* can be defined in many ways, refrain from referring to Deloitte as the *undisputed leader* in any facet of its business and avoid referring to Deloitte people as *undisputed leaders*. Do not equate *undisputed leadership* with being the largest network as ranked by revenue.

It does not need to be capitalized nor set off with quotation marks.

- *Deloitte's aspiration is to become the undisputed leader in professional services.*
- Incorrect: *Deloitte is recognized by analysts as the undisputed leader in mergers and acquisitions services.*
- Incorrect: *Two consultants were recognized as undisputed leaders for providing outstanding client services.*

# How we refer to global Deloitte initiatives

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## World*Class*

World*Class* is Deloitte's social impact effort, with the goal of reaching 100 million people globally by 2030 through education, skills development and access to opportunity.

Do not refer to World*Class* as a *program* or *project*. World*Class* is an umbrella term used to describe our ambition and the many programs/projects around the world that align to it.

It is written as a compound word with both the *W* and the *C* capitalized and *Class* italicized. It doesn't need to be set off with quotation marks.

- Through World*Class*, we are making an impact that matters, one future at a time.

Also see *corporate responsibility/corporate responsibility and sustainability.*

## World*Climate*

World*Climate* is Deloitte's environmental sustainability ambition. It is written as a compound word with both the *W* and the *C* capitalized and *Climate* italicized. It doesn't need to be set off with quotation marks.

Through our World*Climate* ambition we have inspired Deloitte professionals and beyond to make responsible climate choices. Deloitte has set a worldwide science-based target to reach net-zero greenhouse gas emissions (GHGs) by 2040.

# Inclusive language

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Deloitte is committed to providing all its people with an inclusive culture that supports and empowers them to achieve their full potential. The language we use in written content, video scripts, visual presentations and speaking points plays a role in creating and maintaining this environment.

Where the language being used could be potentially viewed as non-inclusive, communicators should consult relevant subject matter experts in the organization; this may include the relevant Inclusion team, Risk or OGC.

# Word usage, grammar and punctuation style

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### Deloitte Global

Deloitte Global uses *The Associated Press (AP) Stylebook* and the *Merriam-Webster dictionary* as its default reference sources. However, because Deloitte is a global network, certain entries are inconsistent with the *AP Stylebook*.

Communications produced by Deloitte Global—regardless of their country of origin—are expected to follow this guidance and should use US English spelling and punctuation.

### Deloitte Insights

Deloitte Insights uses *The Associated Press (AP) Stylebook* and *Webster's New World College Dictionary* as its default reference sources for content other than citations (see *Citations and reference*). For thought leadership intended for a worldwide audience, use American spelling, punctuation and style. Deloitte Insights thought leadership targeting certain regions or countries can use British spelling, punctuation and style if the target audience uses British English conventions. If a piece is for a local audience, use the style of the country for which it's produced. See *A sea of possibilities* and *Voice of Asia* for examples.

### Deloitte firms

Deloitte firms and their related entities are expected to follow this guidance. However, they should adhere to local spelling and punctuation conventions.

# A

## abbreviations/acronyms

In general, spell out the first reference followed by the abbreviation/acronym in parentheses. The acronym should not be in quotation marks.

- *International Financial Reporting Standards (IFRS)*

Exceptions include well-known abbreviations/acronyms such as *AI, NATO, MBA, CEO, PhD and URL*.

The abbreviation/acronym alone may be used on subsequent references. If there is no second reference, the abbreviation/acronym does not need to follow the spelled-out first reference. If the article or publication is very long, it is acceptable to use the full form again in the conclusion for readers' convenience.

Note that in the possessive form of an acronym, the added *s* is not capitalized.

- *The SEC's guidance*
- *NBC's news coverage*

A searchable list of nearly 700 abbreviations/acronyms used at Deloitte can be found here.

## absolutes

Only use absolute statements that can be substantiated. For example, writing, Deloitte is the largest professional services network by global aggregate revenue is a statement we can substantiate.

Avoid absolute statements that cannot be substantiated. For example, avoid saying *Deloitte has the best team in the profession*. Instead, use qualifying words/phrases, such as *one of the best teams in the profession*.

## across/around

Use *across* when referencing entities or specific geographies. Use *around* when referencing round objects, such as a globe or the world.

- *Our goal is consistency across the organization.*
- *The regulations are similar across Europe.*
- *We offer opportunities to people around the world.*
- Incorrect: *Services are available across the globe.*

## adviser/advisor

*Adviser* is the preferred spelling.

## affect/effect/impact

*Affect* as a verb means to influence; *effect* as a noun means result; *effect* as a verb means to bring about. *Impact* as a noun is similar to *effect*. Using *impact* as a verb is considered bad usage; use it sparingly or see whether *affect* can be used instead.

## a.m./p.m.

Always lowercase, always with periods after each letter.
Also see time of day.

# Word usage, grammar and punctuation style

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## among/amongst

In Deloitte Global communications, use *among* rather than *amongst*. This aligns to the Deloitte Global communications preferred style, which is US English (rather than British).

## ampersand (&)

Avoid using the ampersand in text unless it is part of an entity's official name. It may be used in abbreviations for those entities or in other common references.

- *Deloitte Global Clients & Industries (GC&I) delivers services related to industry expertise, account strategy, research, marketing and proposals.*
- *Deloitte is a global leader in mergers and acquisitions (M&A).*
- Incorrect: *DU has locations in North America, Europe & Asia.*

## analyst relations

Use initial caps when referring to the proper name of the function within Deloitte Global, but lowercase when used generally. Never abbreviate in formal communication.

- *Analyst Relations facilitates two-way information exchange between Deloitte and targeted industry analysts to help ensure the Deloitte brand is properly positioned in the marketplace.*
- *A strong analyst relations function is critical.*

## and/or

Where possible, avoid using *and/or* in written communications. In most cases, writers mean either *or* or *and*. For an appropriate alternative when the meaning truly is both, write out *either X, or Y, or both*.

## apostrophe

Use apostrophes to indicate possession. For example:

- Singular possessive*: My client's business (the business of my client)*
- Plural possessive: *My clients' businesses (more than one client)*
- For organization names that end in "s" (e.g., Zappos, Walgreens, McDonald's, etc.), it's preferable to restructure sentences to avoid the possessive form of the organization's name. If the organization's name must be used as a possessive, contact the appropriate lead client service partner to determine how the organization prefers possessive apostrophes be used.

Do not use apostrophes with plurals of numbers or abbreviations.

- *More than 200 CPAs attended the breakfast.*
- *The 1960s were a time of rebellion.*

Use an apostrophe for missing numbers. Make sure you use an apostrophe, not a single quotation mark.

- *The last reorganization was in the '80s.*

## around/across

See across/around.

## assurance

Avoid creating an interpretation that Deloitte gives assurance or Guarantees. (Note: this is a different meaning than the "assurance" services provided through our Audit & Assurance business.) For example, never say *the client will avoid risk by using this approach* because no approach can completely eliminate risk.

- Replace words like *will* and *must* with *may, can, should* or *are designed to*. For example, *can help reduce risk*, *may mitigate risk* or *are designed to reduce risk.*

# B

## baby boom, baby boomers

Deloitte considers the generation born between the end of World War II and December 1964 as baby boomers. *Boomer[s]* is acceptable on second use and later. Lowercase *baby boom, baby boomer[s]* and *boomer[s]* except at the beginning of a sentence. Hyphenate when used as an adjective.

- *He's a member of the baby-boom generation.*

Also see Generation X, millennials, Generation Z.

## biannual/biennial

*Biannual* means twice a year and is a synonym for *semiannual*. *Biennial* means *every two years.*

## Big Four

*Deloitte should not be referred to as part of the Big Four, instead replace with "EY, KPMG and PwC."*

# Word usage, grammar and punctuation style

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## blockchain

One word, lowercase.

## board of directors

Capitalize if referencing the Deloitte Global Board of Directors, but lowercase when used as a generic term. It is acceptable to use "the board" in subsequent references.

- *The Deloitte Global Board of Directors will meet in June. The board's meeting schedule is available on Deloitte Resources.*
- *The proposal needs to be reviewed by the client's board of directors.*

## brackets and parentheses

Use parentheses ( ) for parenthetical matter, and square brackets [ ] to indicate parenthetical matter within parentheses: *(more high-skilled jobs [to support the machines] are less attractive for offshoring)*. In addition, any words added to quoted material should be set off with brackets.

## brand

Unless referring to *Deloitte Global Brand* (the function), *brand* should be lowercase. For detailed information on the Deloitte master brand, visit Brand Space.

## boilerplate

Do not use the word *boilerplate* to describe required language.

## bulleted lists

Start each bulleted item with a capital letter and use punctuation consistently as follows:

- Use a colon to lead into the list.
- If all bullets are complete sentences, use periods after each.
- If the collection of bullets forms one complete sentence, use semicolons after each bullet, with "and" following the semicolon of the second-to-last bullet.
- If bullets are single words or phrases, use no punctuation.

All items in a bulleted list should be grammatically parallel:

- *Ensure consistency*
- *Provide information*
- *Identify opportunities*

In lists where order is important (such as steps for performing a task), use numbers rather than bullets. Otherwise, use bullets.

For ***British English*** reports only:

- each item begins with lower case
- do not use "and" to link the penultimate and last points listed
- if a complete sentence is included within a bullet point, the next bullet point still commences with a lower case letter
- use a full stop only at the end of the final bullet point.

# C

## capitalization

Capitalization should be reserved for proper names (*Center for Banking Solutions*) and formal names of companies' departments and businesses (*Analytic & Forensic Technology*).

Avoid capitalizing concepts, ideas and issues unless they are recognized as proper names.

- Correct: *Our mission and strategy create a foundation for success.*
- Correct: *Deloitte people are guided by the network's Purpose and Shared Values.* (Capitalized because they're recognized as proper names at Deloitte.)
- Incorrect: *He talked about his company's Mission and Vision.*

Don't capitalize generic words such as *practice, team, group* and *department* (*marketing department, HR group, tax practice*).

On second reference: Capitalize the full names of agencies, associations and committees on first reference, but lowercase the generic term on second reference (*US Department of Labor, the department; National Mentoring Committee, the committee*).

Capitalize the full name of Deloitte businesses, industry groups, functions, agencies, associations, etc., but lowercase the generic terms.

# Word usage, grammar and punctuation style

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## capitalization (continued)

- *The Deloitte China Audit & Advisory business provides audit services.*
- *The Deloitte Global TMT Industry group is made up of individual Deloitte firm TMT practices.*
- *Deloitte Global Independence helps partners, professional staff and all others employed by Deloitte understand and comply with applicable independence policies and procedures.*
- *US Department of Labor; the department*
- *Covent Garden Chamber Orchestra; the orchestra*

Capitalize the names of communications vehicles and specific groups. Do not capitalize the stand-alone names of services.

- *The Southeast Asia Transaction Services group showed a video about its transaction services.*
- *The meeting featured the Deloitte Global Securitization group, made up of Deloitte securitization practices.*
- *The* CR Network Newsletter *covers leading corporate responsibility practices and ideas.*

All headlines and subheads should be sentence style; that is, capitalize only the initial letter of the first word and any proper nouns/names.

- *The Deloitte Resources section on corporate responsibility includes the article "What we focus on."*

The proper names of initiatives, programs, message statements, etc., may be initial capped.

- *Green Dot ad campaign*

With people's titles, in general, confine capitalization to formal titles used *directly before* an individual's name. Lowercase and spell out titles when they are not used with an individual's name, when they follow a name, and in constructions that set them off from a name by commas.

- *The organization was led by President Maria Rodriguez, who began her term in 2016.*
- *The organization's president, Maria Rodriguez, began her term in 2016.*
- *Maria Rodriguez, the organization's president, began her term in 2016.*
- *The organization's president began her term in 2016.*

Use a lowercase *g* when referring to a government, e.g., *UK government*, or *coalition government*.

North, south, east or west should not be capitalized unless at the beginning of a sentence.

When referring to a plc, use lower case unless the company specifically uses PLC as part of its name.

If starting a sentence or list with a product name that typically begins with a lowercase letter, capitalize the first letter. Or, better yet, reframe the sentence and begin with a different word.

- Incorrect: *iPhones were introduced in 2007.*
- Correct: *IPhones were introduced in 2007.*
- Correct: *The iPhone was introduced in 2007.*

Also see titles, businesses, industry groups.

Capitalize all words in the name of a designated or branded day, week, month or other time period: *Black History Month, Mental Health Awareness Month, World Religion Day, International Women's Day*. Lowercase the time period in informal descriptions: *Memorial Day weekend, Christmas week.*

Generally, use periods and no space when people use initials instead of a first name unless they prefer no periods. Do not give a name with a single initial (J. Jones) unless it is the person's preference or a first name cannot be learned.

## -centric

Words formed with this suffix should be hyphenated.

- *Deloitte professionals are client-centric.*
- *The university conducted a US-centric survey.*

## cloud computing

*Cloud computing* is the use of remote servers to store data and provide related computing services to large numbers of users. Depending on usage, this can also be referred to as *the cloud*.

Note that *cloud* is lowercase unless starting a sentence or part of a product or service's name.

# Word usage, grammar and punctuation style

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## colon

Do not capitalize the first word after a colon unless it is a proper noun
or the start of a complete sentence.

- *There were three considerations: expense, time and feasibility.*
- *He promised this: The company will make good all the losses.*

Exception: In titles, headlines and subheads, capitalize the first letter after the colon, regardless of whether the material after the colon is a complete sentence. For example, *Connected Health: Making an impact.*

## comma

Use commas to separate elements in a series. The use of a comma before *and* or *or*—known as the serial/Oxford comma—is not required in a simple series, but is permitted, especially in sentences where it would enhance understanding and clarity for the reader.

- Correct: *Deloitte websites typically feature the colors black, white and green.*
- Correct: *Deloitte websites typically feature the colors black, white, and green.*

Use of the serial/Oxford comma is preferred when the series is longer and more complex and is required if *and* is used within the series.

- *His consulting specialties include talent programs and policies, talent strategy and design, and workforce planning and analytics.*

Use a comma to separate the independent clauses in a compound sentence.

- *We will have many challenges, and we can turn them into opportunities.*

Use a comma after a dependent clause that begins a sentence, but not when the clause comes at the end.

- *Because we are led by our Purpose, we always ask what is best for our clients and people.*
- *We always ask what is best for our clients and people because we are led by our Purpose.*

Use a comma to separate groups of three digits in numbers greater than 999.

- *The office housed 2,500 professionals.*
- Exception: *Fortune 1000.*

Do not use a comma between the month and year when the day is excluded.

- *March 2017*, not *March, 2017*

For comma usage in dates, see dates.

## Commitment/committed

Use of the words *commitment* or *committed* when referring to a specific cause or third-party organization can imply a formal action. Support, focus or dedication are suggested alternatives.

## compare to/compare with

Use *compared to* when the intent is to assert, without the need for elaboration, that two or more items are similar.

*She compared her work for women's rights to Susan B. Anthony's campaign for women's suffrage.*

Use *compared with* when juxtaposing two or more items to illustrate similarities or differences.

*His time was 2:11:10, compared with 2:14 for his closest competitor.*

## complement/compliment

*Complement* means to complete, supplement or fill in.
*Compliment* means to praise.

## C-suite

Hyphenated, with a capital C.

# Word usage, grammar and punctuation style

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## comprise/compose/constitute

*Compose* means *to create or put together*. It commonly is used in both the active and passive voices.

- *She composed a song.*
- *The United States is composed of 50 states.*
- *The zoo is composed of many animals.*

*Comprise* means *to contain*, *to include all* or *embrace*. It is best used only in the active voice, followed by a direct object.

- *The United States comprises 50 states.*
- *The jury comprises five men and seven women.*
- *The zoo comprises many animals.*

*Comprised of* (for instance, *The United States is comprised of 50 states*) is incorrect and should not be used.

*Constitute*, in the sense of *form or make up*, may be the best word if neither *compose* nor *comprise* seems to fit.

- *Fifty states constitute the United States.*
- *Five men and seven women constitute the jury.*
- *A collection of animals can constitute a zoo.*

## compound words

The hyphen is a mark of punctuation that not only unites but also separates component words; it facilitates understanding, aids readability and ensures correct pronunciation. The best rule to follow for particular words and phrases is to check *Webster's New World College Dictionary*. However, the following guidelines for deciding when to hyphenate are:

- Two or more adjectives before a noun that act as one idea are connected with a hyphen (often referred to as "one thought" adjectives). Example: *First-class decisions require clear-headed thinking.*
- Use a hyphen in expressions where words have become linked by usage to express one idea. Example: *sister-in-law.*
- When written as words, fractions and cardinal numbers consisting of two words are hyphenated. Example: *twenty-nine.*
- Hyphenate words prefixed by *ex-*, *self-*, *all-* and *cross-*. Examples: *all- inclusive, cross-border.*
- Adverbs ending in *–ly* should not be hyphenated. Example*: fully vested fund.*

Combining two words into one conveys a unit idea that is conveyed more clearly and quickly than the component words appearing in unconnected succession. The best rule to follow for particular words and phrases is to check *Webster's New World College Dictionary*.

- In general, combine words when prefixed by *non-, un-, in-, dis-, co-, hyper-, pre-, re-, post-, out-, bi-, counter-, de-, semi-, mis-, mega-, micro-, inter-, over-* and *under-*. Examples: *nonaffiliated, nonemergency, uninfected, inpatient, disorder, disbar, coworker, hyperactive, preordained, recalibrate, postseason, outmaneuver, biweekly, counterintelligence, demystify, semiliterate, miscalculate, megastructure, microfinance, interoffice, overestimate, underappreciate.*
- Combine words when suffixed by *-wide*. Examples: *nationwide, industrywide, companywide.*
- Combine words when the meaning together is more expressive than using the two words separately. Examples: *blockchain, cybersecurity, aftereffect, afterthought, chairwoman, downshift, highbrow, levelheaded, middleman, overexposed, setback, undercut, viewpoint.*

## coronavirus, COVID-19

*Coronaviruses* are a family of viruses that can cause diseases in humans. A new coronavirus emerged in 2019 which causes a respiratory illness called *COVID-19*. When referring to the resulting pandemic, *COVID-19 pandemic* is preferred on first reference, with *pandemic* acceptable for subsequent references. *COVID* should be all uppercase.

# Word usage, grammar and punctuation style

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## council/counsel

*Council* is an advisory group. *Counsel* is advice or those who provide advice.

## cross-

Compounds formed with *cross-* are hyphenated.

- *This will be a cross-border and cross-functional engagement.*

Also see compound words.

## cryptocurrency

One word, lowercase. Lowercase all references to *bitcoin* and other cryptocurrencies, consistent with the style for conventional currency.

## currency

Spell out *million, billion* and *trillion* in copy. These words may be abbreviated *M*, *B* and *T* only in graphics and only if space or style does not permit spelling out the full words.

Do not leave spaces between the country exchange sign and numbers.

- *The project yielded savings of £683.25.*

In communications intended for a global audience, figures should be expressed in US dollars. Always include *US* (without periods), without a space, before the dollar sign.

- *The price was US$1,250 as of February 2017.*
- *Fees: US$1.2 million.*

In publications intended for a US-only audience, the preceding *US* may be omitted:

- *The US federal government's estimated revenue for fiscal year 2018 is $3.654 trillion.*

## cyber-

The use of *cyber* continues to evolve. Currently, the following are acceptable as one word with no hyphen:

- *cyberattack*, *cyberbullying*, *cybercrime*, *cybersecurity*, *cyberspace*, *cyberthreat*

All other *cyber* references should be spelled as two words with no hyphen, including:

- *cyber event*, *cyber incident*, *cyber liability insurance*, *Cyber Monday*, *cyber risk*, *cyber shopping*, *cyber wargaming*

Hyphenate *cyber-related* when used as a modifier.

# D

## data

The word *data* takes singular verbs and pronouns.

- Correct: *Data is*, *data suggests*
- Incorrect: *Data are*, *data suggest*

*Databank and database should be written as one word; data processing, data center and data set should each be written as two words.*

## dashes

See em dash, en dash and compound words.

## dates

Global communication should be formatted as *day/month/year*. Do not use commas. This style should be spelled out in formal communication.

- Correct: *The conference will be held 12 June 2025.*
- Incorrect: *The conference will be held 12/6/25.*

Exceptions: Deloitte Insights publications, US-only press releases and other publications intended for US-only audiences use the American date style. In the American date style, the date is formatted as *month/day/year*. Use a comma before and after the year. Do not use a comma with only month and year and spell out the month.

- *The office will be closed July 4, 2025, for a national holiday.*
- *The conference will be held in December 2025.*

When including a date range, use *to* and *from* or a dash, but not both:

- *Deloitte is also participating in the Annual Meeting of the World Economic Forum taking place in Davos, Switzerland from 19 January to 23 January.*
- *Deloitte is also participating in the Annual Meeting of the World Economic Forum taking place in Davos, Switzerland,19 January - 23 January.*

# Word usage, grammar and punctuation style

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## dates (continued)

When a month is used with a specific date, abbreviate only *Jan., Feb., Aug., Sept., Oct., Nov. and Dec.* Spell out when using alone or with only a year.

- *January 2016 was a cold month.*
- *The coldest day of the year was 2 Jan.*
- *His birthday is 8 May.*
- *She testified that it was Friday, 3 Dec., when the accident occurred.*

Do not use ordinals (*st*, *th,* or *nd*) with dates.

- *The meeting was held on 28 May (or May 28 in US-only press releases).*

## Day One

Capitalize and spell out as a chronological device for summarizing multiday events such as *Day One*, *Day Two*. Lowercase in casual or conversational references.

## decades

It's preferable to include all four digits when referring to a decade. When the context is clear, however, it's acceptable to use the last two digits preceded by an apostrophe to indicate numerals that are left out. Show plural by adding the letter *s*.

- *He ran the company throughout the 1920s.*
- *Disco music was popular in the '70s.*
- *More organizations are hiring people in their 50s.*

## decision-maker/decision-making

*Decision-maker* and *decision-making* should be hyphenated.

- *As the Deloitte Global business leader, she is the chief decision- maker.*
- *We are evaluating our decision-making process.*
- *The team is responsible for staffing, process design and decision- making.*

## degrees, academic

You can either spell out academic degrees, using lowercase, or use standard abbreviations without periods.

- *She received a bachelor of arts in international studies from Vassar College.*
- *He received a BA in economics from Ohio State University and a PhD in economics from the London School of Economics.*

Use an apostrophe in *bachelor's degree*, *a master's*, etc., but note that there is no possessive in *bachelor of arts, master of science*, etc.

Be aware that degree abbreviations may differ across countries. In the US, for example, a bachelor of science degree is abbreviated as *BS*, while in India it is often abbreviated as *BSc*.

## disrupter/disruptor

*Disrupter* is the preferred spelling.

# E

## e-

For computer-related words, see spelling, computer related.

## e-business/e-commerce/e-learning/e-marketing

Hyphenate with a lowercase *e*, except at the beginning of a sentence.

- *The e-marketing leader sent an email about the meeting.*
- *E-commerce is threatening many traditional retailers.*

## e.g./i.e.

Avoid using these abbreviations in favor of writing the way we speak. Use *for example* rather than *e.g.* Use *that is* or *in other words* rather than *i.e.*

When these phrases are used to introduce parenthetical information in the middle of the sentence, they should be set off with commas on both sides. When used as introductory phrases, they should be followed by a comma.

# Word usage, grammar and punctuation style

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## ellipses (...)

Ellipses are primarily used to signify that some text has been left out, especially in quoted material. In the middle of a sentence, put a space before and after the three dots, which should be typed without any spaces between them. Do not use ellipses at the beginning or end of direct quotes.

- *Using "impact" as a verb has become so common ... that younger speakers appear to regard it as wholly standard usage.*
- *"Our Purpose ... expresses our reason for being," Cruickshank said.*

## em dash (—)

Use the longer em dash (—) to set off a phrase within or at the end of a sentence. An em dash should not have spaces separating it from the words surrounding it.

- *Deloitte's Purpose—making an impact that matters—influences leaders' business decisions.*

People tend to overuse the em dash because they consider it to be multipurpose. See whether some other punctuation (such as parentheses) may be better suited.

## email (noun and verb)

One word, no hyphen.

## email style guide

For guidelines on creating on-brand email communications, see the Email style guide available on Brand Space. (To reach it, you may need to search for "email style guide" on Brand Space.)

## en dash (–)

Use either the shorter en dash (–) or a hyphen (-) for number ranges or for compound words where one part of the word is an open or already hyphenated compound. Use en dashes for minus signs. En dashes, like em dashes and hyphens, should not have spaces around them.

- They invited children aged 5-8.
- In the pre-Gulf War years.

## environmental claims

Deloitte demonstrates its environmental sustainability commitment through its World*Climate* ambition and net-zero by 2040 target.

When writing about Deloitte's World*Climate* ambitions, it is important to be mindful of the language used. *Net-zero, aligned with definitions published by the Science-Based Targets initiative (SBTi)* is the appropriate term. To avoid the risk of greenwashing claims, the following terms (or other similar terms without a generally acknowledged definition) should not be used when publicly discussing Deloitte's climate ambition:

- *Carbon neutral*
- *Carbon negative*
- *Climate positive*
- *Green (also see green)*

## European Union

*Eurozone* is one word and *euro area* is two words.
Abbreviate as EU, without periods. The European Union is a political and economic union of 27 member states. Europe is a continent. These terms should not be used synonymously.

## expert/expertise

Avoid using *expert*, *expertise* or *subject-matter expert* (SME) when referring to a Deloitte person or entity unless the relevant individual is certified in a specific area as an expert. If you have questions around whether you can use the term *expert*, consult with your local risk and/or legal team. *Specialist* is a generally acceptable alternative.

# F

## farther/further

*Farther* refers to physical advancement in distance, while further indicates nonphysical advancement.

## fiscal year

Deloitte Global's fiscal year runs from 1 June through 31 May. Most Deloitte firms share the same fiscal year, but there are exceptions. So, if you're including a reference to a specific Deloitte firm's fiscal year, you should check the dates with the Deloitte firm's legal team.

Format as *FY[20XX]* in copy and headlines (with no space between FY and the year). *Fiscal year [20XX]* also is acceptable.

- *FY2017 results were released in September.*
- *Fiscal year 2017 results were published in September.*

*FY[XX]* is an acceptable abbreviation in charts and exhibits, but not in copy or headlines.

- Avoid *FY17 results were released in September.*

# Word usage, grammar and punctuation style

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## footnotes and endnotes

Footnotes and endnotes are intended to give credit to third parties (including other Deloitte firms) for material borrowed, summarized or paraphrased. When citing a source, be sure to include enough information to permit the reader to independently locate the original source, such as name of the author, title of the publication, publisher, website address, page number, date of publication, etc.

See Appendix B for guidance on citing sources in endnotes.

## Fortune 500

Do not italicize the phrase *Fortune 500*. Do italicize *Fortune* if you're referring to the magazine on its own, not the list of 500 companies.

## fractions

Spell out fractions, using hyphens:

- *three-quarters, two-thirds*

## fundraising, fundraiser

One word in all cases.

# G

## Generation X

Deloitte considers the generation born between January 1965 and December 1982 as *Generation X*. *Gen X* is acceptable on second use and later. *Gen Xer* and *Gen Xers* are acceptable, but their use should be limited. Always uppercase.

Also see Generation Z, millennials.

## Generation Z

Deloitte considers the generation born after January 1995 as Generation Z. Gen Z is acceptable on second use and later. Gen Zer (in reference to an individual member of Gen Z) and Gen Zs (in reference to multiple members of Gen Z) are acceptable. Always uppercase.

Also see Generation X, millennials.

## Generative Artificial Intelligence

A type of artificial intelligence that can create new content in the form of text, code, audio, images, videos, processes, and even the 3D structure of proteins. Spell out completely or use Generative AI on first reference. It is acceptable to abbreviate as GenAI (no space) in subsequent references. Generative (or Gen) should be capitalized even when not starting a sentence. Before creating any assets for Deloitte branded materials using GenAI, please follow these guidelines. GenAI and AI are not permitted to be used in the names of any Deloitte assets, products, offerings or tools. Please direct any questions to the Deloitte AI Institute.

Avoid language that attributes human characteristics to these systems, since they do not have thoughts or feelings but can respond in ways that give the impression that they do. Do not use gendered pronouns in referring to AI tools. And keep in mind that such systems are built by people who have their own human biases and aims.

The terms *artificial intelligence* and *artificial general intelligence* are not synonymous.

## green

Always lowercase *green* unless it begins a sentence.

Going *green* in the corporate context generally refers to a company contributing to something that helps the environment or helps to reduce the negative impact the company may have previously had on the planet. Examples include creating office spaces that can help to reduce emissions or reducing business travel, which cuts emissions.

There is no standard definition and therefore one must use caution when using this term. Since there is no commonly accepted definition, there is a risk of *greenwashing*, the process of conveying a false impression or misleading information about how a company is environmentally friendly. Alternative word choices include *environmentally sustainable*. To avoid the risk of greenwashing claims, the following terms (or other similar terms without a generally acknowledged definition) should not be used when publicly discussing Deloitte's climate ambition (see *environmental claims for additional guidance)*

# Word usage, grammar and punctuation style

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## H

### headlines/headings
Use sentence case (capitalizing only the first word and any proper nouns/names) for headlines, subheads, graph and exhibit headings.

### health care, health tech
Two words, no hyphen, even when used as a modifier.

- *health care system*
- *health tech innovations*

### human sustainability
The long-term, collective well-being of individuals, organizations, and society.

### hyphens
See compound words.

## I

### impact
Use *impact* as a noun. Do not use *impact* as a verb or a verb form.

- Incorrect: *The state of the economy will impact the election.*
- Correct: *The state of the economy will have an impact on the election.*

Also see Deloitte Purpose.

### including, but not limited to
Avoid this cumbersome phrase. In most cases, *including* is sufficient.

### internet/intranet/extranet
Do not capitalize unless it's the first word of a sentence.

### Israel-Hamas war
When referring to the ongoing conflict between Israel and Hamas, *the Israel-Hamas war* is preferred on first reference, with *the war* acceptable for subsequent references. Note that *war* is lowercase in both. Do not use terms such as *Israel-Palestinian war* or *Gaza war*.

This is an evolving topic requiring sensitivity in the language used to describe it. For further guidance, please contact the Deloitte Global Risk review team via the Deloitte Global Risk Portal.

### Iran conflict
When referring to the conflict involving Iran, the Iran conflict is preferred.

### italics
In business communications, italics may be used sparingly to emphasize certain words. **(Italics are used throughout this guide to highlight examples of correct and incorrect usage. For clarity, examples in this entry italicize only words that should be italicized in use.)**

- Deloitte is a leader, but our aspiration is to become the *undisputed* leader.

Use italics, not quotation marks, for titles of newspapers, newsletters, magazines, television series, books, etc.

- In his book *The New Capitalists,* Davis addresses how citizen investors are reshaping the corporate agenda.

Use double quotation marks for titles of shorter traditional media works, including songs, poems, short stories, articles, individual television episodes and other short published works.

- *The Times* article, "Picking Up the Pieces," was much quoted.

### its/their
Do not use *their* when referring to a singular entity.

- *The company revealed an expansion of its operations.*
- *Management decided to increase its commitment to community activities next year.*

# Word usage, grammar and punctuation style

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## J

### Jr./Sr./II

It is not necessary to set off these designations with commas.

- James Flanagan III is the son of James Flanagan Jr.

## K

## L

### large language model (LLM)

A deep learning algorithm that is pre-trained on vast amounts of data to be able to recognize and interpret human language or other types of complex data. It is commonly applied as Generative AI to help generate content.

Lowercase, unless starting a sentence.

### life cycle

Two words, no hyphen, even when used as a modifier.

- *life cycle management*

### livestream

One word, no hyphen.

## M

### may/might

*May* and *might* are sometimes interchangeable, but *might* is also the past tense of may. To avoid confusion, use *may* instead of *might*:

- *The board may consider taking action.*

### machine learning

An application of AI in which computer systems identify patterns in datasets to automatically learn patterns from data and perform specific tasks without being explicitly programmed to do so. Note that *machine learning* is a subset of AI. Examples of machine learning applications include smart devices, language translation, and self-driving cars.

Two words, no hyphen, unless used as an adjective. Lowercase unless starting a sentence.

### measurements

Global communications should provide measurements using the metric system, with the equivalent US Customary System figure in parentheses.

- *The runners covered 100 kilometers (62 miles) in a week.*
- *The vehicle's fuel tank capacity is 53 liters (14 gallons).*

Exceptions: Deloitte Insights publications, US-only press releases and other publications intended for US-only audiences may provide measurements using the US Customary System, with the equivalent metric figure in parentheses.

For guidance on converting measurements between the metric and US systems, see the US National Institute of Standards and Technology website.

# Word usage, grammar and punctuation style

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## metrics

The number of people and locations where Deloitte does business is in the Deloitte profile. Currently, Deloitte has:

- *Over 470,000 people globally*
- *A presence in more than 150 countries and territories*

When referring to Deloitte revenue, use the term *Deloitte aggregate member firm revenue* or *aggregate Deloitte firm revenue* on first reference. In subsequent references, the phrase *Deloitte revenue* may be used.

- *The aggregate Deloitte firm revenue in FY2025 was US$70.5 billion, a 4.8% increase in local currency and a 4.9% increase in US dollars.*

The word *aggregate* should be included when referring to revenue across the network, including when referring to revenue for specific regions, business groups or industries—e.g., *Deloitte aggregate Asia Pacific revenue*, *Deloitte aggregate consulting services revenue* or *Deloitte aggregate financial services revenue*.

## millennials

Deloitte considers the generation born between January 1983 and December 1994 as the *millennial generation*. *Millennials* or *millennial generation* are both acceptable. Though it is sometimes used elsewhere, we do not use *Generation Y* for this group. Lowercase unless it's part of a title (e.g., *2018 Millennial Survey*).

Also see Generation X, Generation Z.

## mindset

One word in all cases.

## money

See currency.

## more than/over

When talking about numbers, *more than* is preferred to *over*. It's meant to be used with rounded numbers, so avoid using *more than* with specific numbers.

- Correct: *More than 100 people attended the luncheon.*
- Incorrect: *More than 93 people attended the luncheon*

These words may be abbreviated as "+" only in graphics and only if space or style does not permit spelling out the full words.

## multi-

Generally, words beginning with *multi-* do not need a hyphen.

- *multimedia, multichannel, multicultural, multigenerational, multifaceted, multilaterally, multimedia, multimillion, multitask*

Exceptions: *multi-factor authentication, multi-industry, multi-level marketers, multi-year*

When in doubt, check the Merriam Webster dictionary.

## multidisciplinary

One word, no hyphen

# N

## net-zero

Hyphenate in all uses.

Deloitte has committed to achieving net-zero GHG emissions across our value chain by 2040, as measured at the aggregate, network-wide level. To support this commitment, we have established a science-based target —validated and published by the Science Based Targets initiative (SBTi) in September 2024—to reduce absolute scope 1, 2, and 3 emissions by 90% by FY2040 from a FY2019 baseline, covering our direct business operations and indirect value chain. The remaining 10% of residual emissions are planned to be neutralized through investment in the permanent removal of carbon.

## non-

The rule of prefixes apply; in general, no hyphen when forming a compound that does not have special meaning and can be understood if not is used before the base word. Use a hyphen, however, before proper nouns or in awkward combinations. Refer to *Webster's New World College Dictionary* for specific words.

- *In the US, do not call 911 in nonemergency situations.*
- *The policy does not apply to non-CPAs and non-Deloitte professionals.*

## next-generation, next-gen

Spell out as *next-generation* or abbreviate and hyphenate as *next-gen*.

- Correct: *Our next-generation technology; next-generation leadership*
- Correct: *Our next-gen technology*
- Incorrect: *Our NextGen leadership program*

# Word usage, grammar and punctuation style

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## numbers

In most uses, spell out numbers one through nine; use numerals for numbers 10 and greater, even when there are mixed uses.

- *We placed 12 chairs around the table, but only nine people showed up to the meeting.*

Exception: For British English reports, write out numbers one through ten and use numerals for numbers 11 and greater. In mixed uses, use numerals: *We placed 12 chairs around the table, but only 9 people showed up to the meeting.*

Exception: Use numerals for addresses, ages, dates, decimals, dimensions, distances, millions/billions/trillions, monetary units, page numbers, percentages, scores, temperatures and times less than/fewer than 10.

- *The office was located at 8 N. Elm St.*
- *Her son was 6 years old.*
- *The next meeting is scheduled 8 May.*
- *He rated the project 8.3 on a scale of 1-10.*
- *The banner was 6 feet long and 2 feet wide.*
- *The client locations were 4 miles apart.*
- *More than 3 million citizens will be subject to the new law.*
- *Please turn to page 9.*
- *Earnings increased 8%.*
- *Our team won the game 3-2.* (No comma before the score.)
- *The event was canceled because it was only 4° outside.*
- *Let's talk again at 3 p.m.*

Exception: Spell out numbers 10 and greater if beginning a sentence.

- *Forty years ago, Jane joined us straight out of college.*
- For longer numbers, try rewriting the sentence so it doesn't begin with a number. Example: *There were 77 people in the room*, not *Seventy-seven people were in the room.*

Even though it's acceptable to begin a sentence with a year, try to avoid it.

Spell out fractions using a hyphen.

- *One-fourth, two-thirds.*

Use the abbreviation *No.* for *number* in conjunction with a figure to indicate position or rank.

- *Deloitte is ranked No. 1 among the Big Four in revenue.*

For larger numbers, use commas where necessary, not periods:

- *1,000* not *1.000*

Numbers used to indicate order (first, second, 10th, 25th, etc.) are called ordinal numbers. In copy, spell out first through ninth: *fourth grade, first base, the First Amendment, he was first in line*. Use figures starting with 10th. In headlines, figures may be used instead of first through ninth if space is an issue: *Mexico ranks 7th in global survey*. Do not superscript ordinals: *14th*, not *14$^{th}$*. Do not use ordinals in dates.

Exception: For British English reports, write out ordinal numbers *first* through *tenth* and use figures starting with *11th*. In mixed uses, use figures: *The hackathon teams placed 3rd and 12th.*

# O

## ongoing

One word, no hyphen.

## over/more than

Although it has become acceptable, try to avoid *over* when talking about numbers. Instead, use *more than*.

- *I have traveled to more than 150 countries* is preferable to *I have traveled to over 150 countries.*

# Word usage, grammar and punctuation style

**IMPORTANT NOTE**
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# P

## percent, percentage, percentage point

Use the *%* sign when paired with a numeral, with no space, in most cases. For amounts less than 1%, precede the decimal with a zero. Spell out in casual use.

- *Unemployment is expected to reach 6%.*
- *The cost of living rose 0.6%.*
- *They have a zero percent chance of success.*

If a sentence begins with a percentage, spell out both the number and
*percent*. Try to avoid this construction, if possible.

- *Ninety-nine percent of sentences don't begin with a number.*

Use a singular verb when a singular word follows *of*; use a plural verb when a plural word follows *of*. If *of* is not used, use a singular verb.

- *He said 50% of the membership was there.*
- *He said 50% of the members were there.*
- *He said 50% was a small turnout.*

For a range, *12% to 15% is preferred; 12%-15%* and *between 12% and 15%* are also acceptable.

Use *percentage*, rather than *percent*, when not paired with a number. (*The percentage of people agreeing is small.)*

Do not use the percent symbol (%) by itself in place of the word "percentage."

Be careful not to confuse *percent* with *percentage point*. A change from 10% to 13% is a rise of 3 percentage points. This is not equal to a 3% change; rather, it's a 30% increase.

Exception: For British English reports, use *per cent*.

## periods

Use a single space after a period at the end of a sentence.

Do not put a period at the end of titles, subtitles, headings, graph and figure titles, column heads in tables, and captions that are not complete sentences.

## policymaker, policymaking

One word, no hyphen, in all cases.

## pre-

Generally, do not hyphenate. For example: *prearrange*, *predispose*, *preeminent*, *preempt*, *preexisting*, *prejudge*, *prepandemic*, *pretax*. Consult Webster's New World College Dictionary for specific words.

## professional services

Professional services are defined as audit and assurance; tax and legal; strategy, risk and transactions; and technology and transformation services. For legal and regulatory reasons, not all Deloitte firms provide legal services.

Neither Deloitte nor Deloitte Global should be referred to as a *professional services firm*. Deloitte should be referred to as *one of the leading professional services networks* (not as *one of the top accounting firms)*.

## profit

Do not reference *profitability* as a goal at Deloitte. Profit is the result of creating impact and serving the public trust. Profit follows Purpose.

## punctuation and fonts

Punctuation marks (commas, semicolons, colons, periods, question marks, quotation marks, parentheses) should be in the font (roman, italic, boldface) of the surrounding text, unless they are part of a title or exclamation in a different font. **(For clarity, examples in this entry italicize only words that should be italicized in use.)**

- James agreed with the editorials in the *Wall Street Journal*, his favorite newspaper. (Note: Comma is roman, not italic.)
- **Warning!** All parts of this datura plant are poisonous. (Note: Exclamation mark is boldface as part of the exclamation.)
- The professor is well-known for his political stance (see his book, *Politics and Pleasures*). (Note: The parenthesis is roman, not italic.)
- The movie *Are You There?* made no sense to anyone in the group. (Note: Question mark, as part of the title, is italic.)

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# Q

## quotation marks

Use double quotation marks to set off dialogue and titles of shorter traditional media works, including songs, poems, short stories, articles, individual television episodes, magazine articles and other short published works.

- *"I love that television show about the Mafia twins," said Max, referring to The Sopranos' episode "Twin Killers."*

Use italics, rather than quotation marks, for titles of newspapers, newsletters, magazines, television series and books. **(For clarity, the two examples that follow italicize only words that should be italicized in use.)**

- In its 2016 *Report to Shareholders*, the leadership team stressed accountability for the initiative.
- The *Financial Times* article, "Picking Up the Pieces," was much quoted.

For global-level content, follow US English punctuation. Periods and commas go inside quotation marks.

- *The lawyer said, "I don't think we have a case."*
- *The lawyer said, "I don't think we have a case," but the client disagreed.*

If text inside quotation marks is a question, the question mark supersedes the comma.

- *"Is the plan ready?" she asked.*

Colons and semicolons go outside the quotation marks, as do exclamation points and question marks, unless they are part of the quoted materials.

- *Men report being "very satisfied with career opportunities"; fewer women agree with the statement.*
- *He said, "Can we move the meeting to Friday?"*
- *What do you think of the "new method"?*
- *He responded, "Amazing!"*
- *I can't wait to use the "new method"!*

Use quotation marks around unfamiliar terms on the first reference.

- *"SOX" refers to the Sarbanes-Oxley Act.*

If a paragraph ends with a quotation and is followed by a paragraph that continues the quotation, do not put close-quote marks at the end of the first paragraph. Do, however, put open-quote marks at the start of the second paragraph. Continue in this fashion for any succeeding paragraphs, using close-quote marks only at the end of the quoted material.

- *He said, "It was a very productive meeting.*

  *"It was so productive, in fact, that we should finalize the project a month early."*

Exception: Use close-quote marks at the end of the first paragraph if the quoted material does not constitute a full sentence.

- *He said the meeting he attended was "very productive."*

  *"It was so productive, in fact, that we should finalize the project a month early," he said.*

Single quotation marks should only be used for a quote within a quote.

- *The article "How I Said 'No' to the Tax Inspector and Survived" received wide circulation.*

Exception: For British English reports, double quotation marks should only be used if you are quoting directly from a source, or for title of shorter published works. Otherwise, use single quotation marks.

Use curly (or "smart") quotes, rather than straight quotes (which denote measurements in feet and inches).

Don't add quote marks to acronyms in parentheses.
Incorrect example: *The Security & Exchange Commission ("SEC")*

Don't put quotes around words or expressions that are commonly understood and aren't part of quoted material.

Incorrect example: *Our "one-stop-shop" procedure...; Our "fresh eyes" will review...*

## quotes and paraphrasing

All quotes or paraphrases must be attributed to a source. If a quote or paraphrase is from an unpublished source, you must have explicit written permission from the source to publish it in a Deloitte communication. If a quote or paraphrase is from a published source, you should provide attribution in the copy.

# Word usage, grammar and punctuation style

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## quotes and paraphrasing (continued)

- *The number of incidents has increased 225% during the past decade, according to* Harvard Law Review.

Unless referring to timebound research or conversations conducted in the past with clear timing indications given to the reader, quote sources in the present tense.

- *"We have grown our business dramatically," the CEO says*, not *"We have grown our business dramatically," the CEO said*.

# R

## revenue

The singular form is preferable to the plural *revenues*.

- *Deloitte revenue in FY2021 was US$50.2 billion*.

Also see metrics.

## roadmap

One word.

## Russia-Ukraine war

When referring to the ongoing conflict between Russia and Ukraine, *the Russia-Ukraine war* is preferred on first reference, with *the war in Ukraine* acceptable for subsequent references. Note that *war* is lowercase in both.

Avoid referring to the *Donetsk People's Republic (DPR)* or the *Luhansk People's Republic (LPR)*. Instead, *certain areas of the Donetsk and Luhansk regions* or *Russian-occupied territories of Ukraine* are preferred. When referring to the capital of Ukraine, note that the correct spelling is *Kyiv* (not *Kiev*).

This is an evolving topic requiring sensitivity in the language used to describe it. For further guidance, please contact the Deloitte Global Risk review team via the Deloitte Global Risk Portal.

# S

## scope 1, 2, 3 emissions

The three emission "scopes," *scope 1, 2 and 3*, are defined by the Greenhouse Gas (GHG) Protocol as a way of categorizing the different kinds of emissions a company creates in its own operations and in its wider value chain. *Scope 1* includes the direct emissions from sources owned or controlled by an organization, such as fuel combustion in buildings and vehicles. Conversely, *scopes 2 and 3* represent indirect emissions that are consequences of the activities undertaken by an organization but outside of their direct ownership or control. Common sources include purchased electricity (for scope 2) and other indirect sources such as business travel and purchased goods and services (for scope 3).

Lowercase *scope* unless starting a sentence.

## seasons

Avoid references to *spring*, *summer*, *fall/autumn* and *winter* because seasons differ depending on whether readers reside in the Northern or Southern hemispheres.

## semicolons

In general, use the semicolon to indicate a greater separation of thought and information than a comma can convey, but less than the separation that a period implies. Semicolons may be used in place of *and* or *but*.

- *The results demonstrate the wisdom of our approach; we've seen significant changes benefiting all of our people.*
- *The package was due last week; it arrived today.*

To avoid confusion, use semicolons in a series that already has commas in it.

- *The committee members came from Bologna, Italy; Columbus, Ohio, US; and Mendoza, Argentina.*

Use a semicolon before and a comma after any of the following words if they are used to connect two sentences (compound sentences): *however, therefore, for example, accordingly, for instance, that is, moreover, instead, thus*.

- *The team wanted to complete the game; however, the umpires decided that the ground was too wet to continue.*

Place semicolons outside quotation marks.

# Word usage, grammar and punctuation style

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## skill set

Two words.

## -sharing

Terms ending in *-sharing* should be treated as compound terms with a hyphen, such as *ride-sharing*, *cost-sharing*, *data-sharing*.

## slashes

Slashes should be used sparingly, but if they are necessary, do not include spaces around them.

- Correct: *he/she*
- Incorrect: *he / she*

## spelling

See Appendix A for a selection of words that are spelled differently in American and British English.

## spelling, computer-related

Here's the preferred spelling of technical and internet-related terminology (including capitalization and hyphenation):

add-on
back end (n.)
back- end (adj.)
database
dropdown e-business
e-commerce
e-communications
e-learning
email
e-marketing
end user (n.) end-user (adj.) e-room
extranet
front end (n.) front-end (adj.)
homepage
in-house (adj., adv.) internet
intranet
log in/log on/log out (v.) login/logon (n., adj.)
offline
offsite (adj., adv.)
online
onsite (adj., adv.) plugin (adj., n.)
podcast
pulldown (adj.)
real-time (adj.)
site map
startup (adj., n.) start up (verb) URL
user ID
web
webcast
webmaster website
World Wide Web

## sports metaphors

Avoid sports metaphors, which are often cliches and may not be understood by a diverse, global audience.

Examples: *ball in your court, clean bowled, curveball, down to the wire, dropped the ball, full-court press, get the ball rolling, in pole position, jump the gun, knocked for six, knocked it out of the park, leveling the playing field, Monday-morning quarterback, on back foot, par for the course, pass the baton, slam dunk, scoring a touchdown, under the wire*

## subject matter expert (SME)

See expert/expertise.

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# T

## telehealth, telemedicine

Both are one word, no hyphen.

## telephone numbers

Use spaces, not dashes, to separate numbers.

- *+1 81 3 3457 7321*

Country codes are required for direct international dialing. A plus sign (+) precedes the country code (81 for Japan in the example above), which indicates that an international access code is required.

## temperatures

Use numerals for temperatures. Use the degree symbol (°), rather than spelling out *degrees,* and the abbreviations *C* or *F* to indicate *Celsius* or *Fahrenheit*.

Global communications should provide a temperature in Celsius, with the equivalent temperature in Fahrenheit in parentheses. Generally, it's preferable to round temperatures to the nearest whole number, though decimals can be used if a more precise figure is required.

- *The day's high was expected to be 25° C (77° F).*
- *Temperatures fell to -23.5° C (-10.3° F).*
- *The temperature dropped by 10° C (18° F).*

Exceptions: Deloitte Insights publications, US-only press releases and other publications intended for US-only audiences may provide temperatures in Fahrenheit, with the equivalent temperature in Celsius in parentheses.

Additionally, for some widely recognized numbers, either Celsius or Fahrenheit is the appropriate temperature scale to use, regardless of geography, and does not need to be converted.

To convert to Fahrenheit, multiply a Celsius temperature by 9, divide by 5 and add 32.

To convert to Celsius, subtract 32 from the Fahrenheit temperature, multiply by 5 and divide by 9.

To convert a temperature *difference* from Celsius to Fahrenheit, multiply by 9 and divide by 5.

To convert a temperature *difference* from Fahrenheit to Celsius, multiply by 5 and divide by 9.

## templates

PowerPoint, proposal and video templates are available on Brand Space, prepopulated with everything necessary to seamlessly integrate the Deloitte brand into communications.

## that/which

*That* is used for an essential clause.

- *The house that is painted white is mine.*

*Which* introduces a nonessential clause that could be omitted without changing the meaning. *Which* clauses are always set off by commas.

- *The house, which was built in 1940, is white.*

## time frame

Two words, no hyphen.

## time of day

Use the clock time in force where the event happened or will take place and follow the local time with Greenwich Mean Time (GMT).

- *The meeting in Rome will kick off at 8 a.m. (6 a.m. GMT).*
- *The press conference will be held in Chicago and begin at 2 p.m. (8p.m. GMT)*

For a.m. and p.m., use periods with a lowercase format.

Do not use military (24-hour) time in business communications unless the publication is produced in British English, in which case it would be *18.00*, not *6 p.m.*

# Word usage, grammar and punctuation style

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## titles (of compositions)

Capitalize all words in the titles of books, movies, plays, poems, albums, songs, operas, radio and television programs, lectures, speeches, and works of art—except articles (a, an, the); prepositions of three or fewer letters (for, of, on, up, etc.); and conjunctions of three or fewer letters (and, but, for, nor, or, so, yet, etc.) unless any of those start or end the title.

Italicize composition titles except for holy books (e.g., the Bible, the Quran, etc.) and catalogs of reference material (e.g., dictionaries, handbooks, etc.).

Use double quotation marks for titles of shorter traditional media works, including articles, individual television episodes and other short published works.

- *The Times* article, "Picking Up the Pieces," was much quoted.

Include The when part of a publication's official name.

- *The New York Times, The Economist, The Wall Street Journal*

This guidance applies to composition titles and shorter media works that are referenced in Deloitte content. It does not apply to headlines/headings of Deloitte works, which use sentence case.

Also see headlines/headings, italics.

## Tohmatsu

Phonetically, *Tohmatsu* is pronounced *Toe' mahtz*, with the accent on the first syllable. Do not pronounce the *u* at the end.

## toward/towards

Preferred usage is *toward*.

## town hall

Two words, no hyphen.

## trend line

Two words, no hyphen.

## Tweet

Avoid the terms *tweet* or *tweeted*. Instead use *posted on the social platform X or posted on X*.

# U

## under/fewer than/less than

Try to avoid *under* when talking about numbers. In general, use *fewer* and *fewer than* for individual items, *less* and *less than* for quantity.

- Correct: *The audit revealed fewer than a dozen errors.*
- Correct: *Our office's donation amount was less than your office's amount.*
- Correct: *I had less than US$50 in my pocket* (an amount); *I had fewer than 50 bills in my pocket* (individual items).
- Incorrect: *The audit revealed under a dozen errors.*
- Incorrect: *The trend is toward more machines and less people.* (People in this sense refers to individuals.)
- Incorrect: *She was fewer than 60 years old.* (Years in this sense refers to a period of time, not individual years.)

## United Kingdom/UK

Spell out when used as a noun. Abbreviate when used as an adjective; do not use periods with *UK*.

- *She lives in the United Kingdom.*
- *We are working closely with UK regulators.*

## United States/US/USA

Acceptable to spell out or use *US* when used as a noun. Abbreviate as *US* when used as an adjective. Do not use periods with *US*. Avoid *USA*.

- *He grew up in the United States before moving to France.*
- *The innovative product was awarded a US patent.*
- *We are the largest professional services organization in the US.*

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## V

### versus

Spell out *versus* in ordinary speech and writing.

- *The proposal to revamp Medicare versus proposals to reform Medicare and Medicaid at the same time …*

The abbreviation *vs.* is permitted in headlines, subheads, and titles on data visualizations.

For court cases, use *v.*

- *Marbury v. Madison*

## W

### web

Lowercase *web* when used as a shortened version of *World Wide Web (*which is a proper name and should be capitalized).

Also see spelling, computer related for other guidance (including *webmaster* and *website*).

### well-being

Two words, with a hyphen, is preferred.

### while/whilst

In Deloitte Global communications, use *while* rather than *whilst*. This aligns to the Deloitte Global communications preferred style, which is US English (rather than British).

### who/whom

*Who* is used when referring to the subject of a sentence. *Whom* is used when referring to the object or when governed by a preposition.

- *I wish I knew who wrote it.*
- *Whom should I see when I arrive?*
- *We know whom to approach to help us find the answer .*

### -wide

Do not use a hyphen. For example, *citywide*, *countrywide*, *firmwide*, *industrywide*, *organizationwide*, *worldwide*.

Also see compound words.

### Wi-Fi

Use a hyphen and capitalize both the *W* and *F*.

### work/life

Use a slash with no spaces on either side.

- *Coaching programs for new mothers returning from family leave help them adjust to their new work/life balance.*

### workstream

Project activities grouped together and often running in parallel. One word.

## Y

### year over year

Hyphenate when used as a modifier, but not otherwise.

- *Aggregated Deloitte firm revenue increased 12% year over year.*
- *The company has shown impressive year-over-year sales increases.*

In charts, the abbreviation *YoY* is acceptable.

## Z

### zero trust

Always lowercase unless it's beginning a sentence, then capitalize *zero*
only. No hyphen is necessary.

- *Zero trust security means that no one is trusted by default from inside or outside the network.*
- *The zero trust model requires strict identity verification from everyone trying to access a network.*

# Citations and reference

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For citations, Deloitte Global and Deloitte Insights follow the Chicago Manual of Style. **(Italics are used throughout the *Deloitte Language and Style Guide* to highlight examples of correct and incorrect usage. However, examples are not italicized in the *Citations and reference* section so that the proper use of italics in citations can be illustrated clearly.)**

## Titles: In-text references and endnotes for books, periodicals, magazines, journals and newspapers

For publications that contain multiple individual chapters or articles, use title case for the publication's main title and all subtitles (whether set off from the main title with a colon or placed on a separate line), and
italicize the publication's main title and all subtitles. However, do not italicize and capitalize the word *magazine* if it is not part of the publication's formal name (*Deloitte Life* magazine, not *Deloitte Life Magazine*). Similarly, do not italicize and capitalize *the* in newspaper and magazine titles (the *Economist* and the *New York Times*). Foreign- language titles, however, retain the article in the original language—but only if it is an official part of the title (*Le Monde* is one on the best- selling newspapers in France).

- As Michael Raynor says in *The Innovator's Manifesto: Deliberate Disruption for Transformational Growth* ...
- Preface to *Business Trends 2013*
- In March 2013, the *Economist* published an article ...

## Chapters or articles within a book, periodical or other compilation

For individual chapters or articles contained in a book, periodical or other compilation, use sentence case for the chapter or report title and all subtitles (whether set off from the main title with a colon or placed on a separate line), and enclose the title of the chapter or article in quotation marks. Capitalize the first letter after the colon.

- The article "Cloud wars: How incumbents can respond to cloud disruption" appears in issue 11 of *Deloitte Review*.
- In March 2013, the *Economist* published an article about electronic cigarettes titled "No smoke. Why the fire?"

## Stand-alone reports

For stand-alone reports, use sentence case for the title and all subtitles (whether set off from the main title with a colon or placed on a separate line), and italicize the report title and all subtitles. Capitalize the first letter after the colon.

- In *Innovation in insurance: The path to progress*, the authors describe examples of empowering, sustaining and efficiency innovations in the insurance industry.

## Endnotes and sources

All sources for cited statistics should appear in endnotes at the end of the publication. The endnotes should use Arabic numbering (1, 2, and so on). Additionally, all "aside" notes should also appear as endnotes.

In-text references should appear as superscript numbers at the end of the cited statistic or statement—after the punctuation mark(s) for all punctuation except for the em dash, which the reference precedes. If there is more than one statistic that requires citation, the in-text reference should appear at the end of each relevant clause.

- The company allows employees to work "anywhere, anytime."[32]
- As of 1990, the birth rate had dropped below 1.5 births per woman[1]—with a further decline to 1.4 in 2000 and 1.3 in 2010.[2]
- Additional analyses that can help a company improve its sustainability strategy include:[4]
- (endnote) 3. "Irrational expectations," *Deloitte Review* 4 (2009); "Beyond the numbers," *Deloitte Review* 8 (2011).

Although more than one note reference should never appear at a single location (such as 5, 6), a single note can contain more than one citation or comment. In the corresponding endnote, the multiple sources should be separated by semicolons.

- (In text) In previous articles, we have discussed the ways in which business analytics is more than a story about arcane statistical algorithms, big data management, and information technology.[3]
- (Endnote) 3. "Irrational expectations," *Deloitte Review* 4 (2009); "Beyond the numbers," *Deloitte Review* 8 (2011).

## LinkedIn articles/posts

LinkedIn articles and posts are not regarded as credible sources, as content on the platform can be published by anyone without undergoing a formal review or verification process.

# Citations and reference

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## General guidance on citations: Mandatory source info

While not all the sources in the endnotes may include all the details listed in Appendix B, a source *must* include an author (individual or agency), publication title and date published (or date accessed or modified for online resources).

## No authors

Publications such as research/position papers and reports often do not identify the authors; in such cases, treat the organization publishing the report as the author. If it is difficult to identify the exact name of the organization or business, use the name of the organization that appears in the copyright line (usually found on the last page).

## Author format in endnotes

In endnotes, author names should follow the format *first name*, *middle initial* (if known), *last name*. For two authors, separate the names with *and*. For three or more authors, separate the names using commas, and put *and* before the last author's name.

- John D. Kelly
- Geoffrey C. Ward and Ken Burns
- Dana L. Barnes, James Brown, and Lily Thomas

## Hyperlinking

When a report hyperlinks to web sources, the source should also be cited in endnotes.

## Date format

Dates (especially access dates) should follow the format *month/day/ year* (for instance, July 26, 2011) in citations. Dates with only *month and year* (for journals, for instance) don't need a separating comma (February 2012). For date format other than in citations, see the dates entry in the *Word usage, grammar and punctuation style* section.

## Page numbers

Include page numbers for all print and PDF sources if possible.

## Period at the end of endnotes

Each endnote and each listing in a bibliography must have a period at the end.

For a source that is repeated in the endnote that immediately follows, do not repeat the entire source information; instead use the term *ibid*. (short for *ibidem*, meaning *in the same place*). *Ibid*. is capitalized at the beginning of a note, set in plain text (not italicized) and followed by a period. For repeat references that don't immediately follow the first reference, use the format in the column "Endnote—repeat reference" in Appendix B.

## Online sources

For online sources, include an access date if there is no print publication date given. Names of websites should be set in roman and title case (Google Maps, Yahoo.com), but italicized if the title is analogous to a book or magazine title (*Slate*, *AP Stylebook Online*).

For source citations that are meant to be presented and read *online*, including in manuscripts prepared for Deloitte Insights publication, hyperlink the title of an online source to its URL. For source citations meant to be read *offline* (including in PDFs), hyperlinking the title is not necessary, nor is it necessary to provide a URL in the citation.

When hyperlinking a title enclosed in quotation marks, do not hyperlink the surrounding quotes or punctuation.

- Do: Erik Wasson, "Harvey may spur Congress to avoid shutdown, debt-ceiling fights," Bloomberg, August 30, 2017.
- Don't: Erik Wasson, "Harvey may spur Congress to avoid shutdown, debt-ceiling fights," Bloomberg, August 30, 2017.

However, include punctuation that is part of the title in the hyperlink:

- Do: Chris Bryant, "Are Brits losing their taste for Porsche and Mercedes?" Bloomberg, October 23, 2017.
- Don't: Chris Bryant, "Are Brits losing their taste for Porsche and Mercedes?" Bloomberg, October 23, 2017.

## Omit *the* in magazine names

Do not use the preceding *the* in magazine, newspaper and journal titles in endnotes.

- Nicole LaPorte, "Where apps become child's play," *New York Times*

## Bibliography

Bibliographies are generally used only in books. Normally, footnotes or endnotes list individual notes, and the bibliography lists in alphabetical order all the sources consulted in the research (even if these sources are not specifically cited in the endnotes). In bibliographies, author names should follow the *last name, first name, middle initial* (if known) format:

- Johnson, Jason R.

**Appendix B lists the format for citing sources in endnotes and in a bibliography.**

# Appendix A: US and UK spelling

This selection of words shows the main differences between US and UK spelling

| US | UK |
|---|---|
| acknowledgment | acknowledgement |
| airplane | aeroplane |
| aluminum | aluminium |
| among | amongst |
| analog | analogue (applies to many other words ending og/ogue) |
| ax | axe |
| behavior | behaviour (applies to many other words ending or/our) |
| catalog | catalogue |
| center | centre (applies to many other words ending er/re) |
| check | cheque |
| checkered | chequered |
| color | colour |
| counterclockwise | anti-clockwise |
| curb | kerb |
| defense | defence |
| digitize | digitise (applies to many other words that include the letter z) |
| distill | distil |
| draft | draught |
| fiber | fibre |
| fueled | fuelled (and similar words with l/ll occurrences, but note fulfill/fulfil and skillful/skilful) |
| furor | Furore |
| labor | Labour |
| maneuver | manoeuvre |
| meter | metre |
| mold/molt | mould/moult |
| mustache | moustache |
| organization | organisation |

| US | UK |
|---|---|
| plow | plough |
| prioritize | prioritise |
| program | programme |
| skepticism | scepticism |
| skillful | skilful |
| specialty | speciality |
| sulfur | sulphur |
| tire | tyre |
| toward | towards |
| traveled | travelled |
| while | whilst |

# Appendix B: Format for citing sources in endnotes and in a bibliography

| Type of source | Endnote—first reference | Endnote—repeat reference | Bibliography |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Book (one to three authors)** | Author(s), *Complete Title* (Place: Publisher, Year), Page number(s).<br><br>For instance:<br><br>Malcolm Gladwell, *Blink: The Power of Thinking without Thinking* (New York: Little, Brown and Company, 2005), pp. 99–100.<br><br>Michael Raynor and Mumtaz Ahmed, *The Three Rules: How Exceptional Companies Think* (New York: Portfolio/ Penguin, 2013), p. 52. | Author last name, *Short Title*, Page number(s).<br><br>For instance: Gladwell, *Blink*, p. 3.<br><br>Raynor and Ahmed, *The Three Rules*, p. 85. | Author last name, First name. *Complete Title*. Place: Publisher, Year.<br><br>For instance:<br><br>Gladwell, Malcolm. *Blink: The Power of Thinking without Thinking*. New York: Little, Brown and Company, 2005.<br><br>Raynor, Michael, and Mumtaz Ahmed. *The Three Rules: How Exceptional Companies Think*. New York: Portfolio/Penguin, 2013. |
| **Book (four or more authors)** | First author et al., *Complete Title* (Place: Publisher, Year), Page number(s).<br><br>For instance:<br><br>Jane Reece et al., *Campbell Biology*, 9th ed. (San Francisco: Benjamin Cummings, 2010), p. 178. | Last name of first author et al., *Short Title*, Page number(s).<br><br>For instance:<br><br>Reece et al., *Campbell Biology*, pp. 20–22. | Last name, First name, of first author and First name Last name of other authors. *Complete Title*. Place: Publisher, Year.<br><br>For instance:<br><br>Reece, Jane, Lisa Urry, Michael Cain, Steven Wasserman, Peter Minorsky, and Robert Jackson *Campbell Biology*. 9th ed. San Francisco: Benjamin Cummings, 2010. |
| **Book chapter/section** | Author, "Chapter title," *Book Title* (Place: Publisher, Year), Page number(s).<br><br>For instance:<br><br>Henry Chesbrough, "The path to open innovation," *Open Business Models: How to Thrive in the New Innovation Landscape* (Boston: Harvard Business School Press, 2006), p. 23. | Author last name, "Short chapter title," Page number(s).<br><br>For instance:<br><br>Chesbrough, "The path to open innovation," pp. 24–25. | Author last name, First name. "Chapter title." *Book Title*. Place: Publisher, Year.<br><br>For instance:<br><br>Chesbrough, Henry. "The path to open innovation." In *Open Business Models: How to thrive in the New Innovation Landscape*. Boston: Harvard Business School Press, 2006. |

# Appendix B: Format for citing sources in endnotes and in a bibliography

| Type of source | Endnote—first reference | Endnote—repeat reference | Bibliography |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Article in newspaper or magazine, both print and online editions (for online uses, hyperlink the source's title to the page's URL or DOI, if available)** | Author, "Article title," *Newspaper/Magazine Title*, Date of publication, Page number(s), if available.<br><br>For instance:<br>Nathan Heller, "Bay watched: How San Francisco's new entrepreneurial culture is changing the country," *New Yorker*, 14 October 2013, p. 68. | Author last name, "Short article title," Page number(s).<br><br>For instance:<br>Heller, "Bay watched," p. 69. | Author last name, First name. "Article title." *Newspaper/Magazine Title*, Date of publication.<br><br>For instance:<br>Heller, Nathan. "Bay watched: How San Francisco's new entrepreneurial culture is changing the country." *New Yorker*, 14 October 2013. |
| **Journal article (for online uses, hyperlink the source's title to the page's URL or DOI, if available)** | Author, "Article title," *Journal Title* Volume number, Issue number (Year): Page number(s).<br><br>For instance:<br>Jay Levinson, "Israeli response to mass death," *Disaster Prevention and Management* 20, no. 5 (2011): pp. 487–88. | Author last name, "Short article title," Page number(s).<br><br>For instance:<br>Levinson, "Israeli response to mass death," pp. 487–88. | Author last name, First name. "Article title." *Journal Title* Volume number, Issue number (Year): Page range of complete article.<br><br>For instance:<br>Levinson, Jay. "Israeli response to mass death." *Disaster Prevention and Management* 20, no. 5 (2011): pp. 487–88. |

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| Type of source | Endnote—first reference | Endnote—repeat reference | Bibliography |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Research/position paper or report published by an organization (for online uses, hyperlink the source's title to the page's URL or DOI, if available)** | Author(s) if available, *Report title*, Name of organization, Date of publication, Page number(s).<br><br>For instance:<br>Carolyn Heller Baird and Gautam Parasnis, *From social media to social CRM: What customers want*, IBM Corporation, 2011, p. 7.<br><br>IF NO AUTHOR IS GIVEN:<br><br>Name of organization, *Report title*, Date of publication, Page number(s).<br><br>For instance:<br>Deloitte US, *Banking and securities outlook 2012: A year of resolution and revolution*, 2011, p. 4. | Author last name(s), *Short report title*, Page number(s).<br><br>For instance:<br>Baird and Parasnis, *From social media to social CRM*, p. 3.<br><br>IF NO AUTHOR IS GIVEN:<br><br>Organization name, *Short report title*, Page number(s).<br><br>Deloitte US, *Banking and securities outlook 2012: A year of resolution and revolution, 2011*, p. 4. | Author last name, First name. *Report title*. Name of business or organization. Date of publication.<br><br>For instance:<br>Baird, Carolyn Heller, and Gautam Parasnis. *From social media to social CRM: What customers want. IBM Corporation. 2011.*<br><br>IF NO AUTHOR IS GIVEN:<br><br>Name of organization. *Report title*. Date of publication. URL, Last modified/access date.<br><br>For instance:<br>Deloitte US. *Banking and securities outlook 2012: A year of resolution and revolution. 2011.* |
| **Paper or presentation at a meeting or conference (for online uses, hyperlink the source's title to the page's URL or DOI, if available)** | Author, "Paper title," Meeting/conference name, Location, Date.<br><br>For instance:<br>David Wong, Amit Chanda, and Parker Paulin, "BRCM: LTE baseband to simple—rising estimates," presented at Broadcom 2012 Analyst Day, 6 December 2012. | Author last name, "Short paper title."<br><br>For instance:<br>Wong, Chanda, and Paulin, "BRCM." | Author last name, First name. "Paper title." Meeting/conference name, Location, Date.<br><br>For instance:<br>Wong, David, Amit Chanda, and Parker Paulin. "BRCM: LTE baseband to simple—rising estimates." Presented at Broadcom 2012 Analyst Day, 6 December 2012. |

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| Type of source | Endnote—first reference | Endnote—repeat reference | Bibliography |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Interviews or personal communication** | Source name (Professional title), Communication details, Date of communication.<br><br>For instance:<br>Janet Mason (assistant deputy minister, Ministry of Municipal Affairs and Housing, Ontario), email interview with the author, 5 April 2012. | Source last name, brief communication details.<br><br>For instance:<br>Mason interview. | Source last name, First name (Professional title). Communication details. Date of communication.<br><br>For instance:<br>Mason, Janet (assistant deputy minister, Ministry of Municipal Affairs and Housing, Ontario). Email interview with the author. 5 April 2012. |
| **News services (such as AP or Reuters) if no author is given (for online uses, hyperlink the source's title to the page's URL or DOI, if available)** | News service name, "Title of article," *Title of the reporting publication if applicable*, Publication date.<br><br>For instance:<br>Associated Press, "Texas A&M Galveston professor fails entire class, quits course," *Dallas Morning News*, 28 April 2015. | News service name, "Short title of article."<br><br>For instance:<br>Associated Press, "Texas A&M Galveston professor fails entire class." | News service name. "Title of article." *Title of the reporting publication if applicable*, Publication date.<br><br>For instance:<br>Associated Press. "Texas A&M Galveston professor fails entire class, quits course." *Dallas Morning News*, 28 April 2015. |
| **Press release (note that it is identified as a press release after the press release's title; for online uses, hyperlink the source's title to the page's URL or DOI, if available)** | Organization issuing the press release, "Title of press release," press release, date.<br><br>For instance:<br>Deloitte Canada, "Deloitte, Senior Executives Association Survey: Leadership pipeline, readiness and transformation abilities among top concerns for federal executives," press release, 4 October 2017. | Organization issuing the press release, "Short title of press release."<br><br>For instance:<br>Deloitte Canada, "Deloitte, Senior Executives Association Survey." | Organization issuing the press release. "Title of press release." Press release, date.<br><br>For instance:<br>Deloitte Canada. "Deloitte, Senior Executives Association Survey: Leadership pipeline, readiness and transformation abilities among top concerns for federal executives." Press release, 4 October 2017. |

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| Type of source | Endnote—first reference | Endnote—repeat reference | Bibliography |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Website for original content other than the types of sources discussed earlier (for online uses, hyperlink the source's title to the page's URL or DOI, if available)** | Site publisher or owner, “Page name," Last modified/accessed date.<br><br>For instance:<br>McDonald’s Corporation, “Corporate info,” accessed 2 November 2012. | Site publisher or owner, "Short page name."<br><br>For instance:<br>McDonald's Corporation, “Corporate info.” | Site publisher or owner. "Page name." Last modified/accessed date.<br><br>For instance:<br>McDonald’s Corporation. “Corporate info.” accessed 2 November 2012. |
| **Online multimedia content (include as much information as possible in the media details, and for online uses, hyperlink the source's title to the page's URL or DOI, if available)** | Publisher or site owner, “Media title,” Media type, Media details, posted date/last accessed date.<br><br>For instance:<br>Deloitte Insights, “The exceptional company: Defying gravity," video featuring Michael Raynor, 2:14, 10 January 2014.<br>YouTube, “Toyota’s CIO Zack Hicks - Enabling the dream,” video, 3:26, 19 October 2016. | Publisher or site owner, "Short media title.“<br><br>For instance:<br>Deloitte Insights, “The exceptional company.”<br><br>YouTube, “Toyota's CIO Zack Hicks.” | Publisher or site owner. "Media title." Media type, Media details. Posted date/last accessed date.<br><br>For instance:<br>Deloitte Insights. “The exceptional company: Defying gravity.” Video featuring Michael Raynor, 2:14. 10 January 2014.<br>YouTube. “Toyota’s CIO Zack Hicks - Enabling the dream.” Video, 3:26. 19 October 2016. |

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